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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, June 15, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KHKFCuUFKus
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:10:16] Ladies and gentlemen, welcome to the business meeting of the Virginia Board of Education, as we like to refer to ourselves, the hardest working unpaid board in the Commonwealth. Six years of starting meetings on time. We were almost late today, so I appreciate everybody sitting down right at the right moment. Okay, we will begin the meeting with a moment of silence.

[00:10:41] In addition to our normal moment of silence, I'd like to just reflect for a minute about the events of last week um you know i was a board member in chesterfield as some of you know and the hardest day i had on the board was the day that we lost uh the life of a child in our in our care you know it's a day that stays with me still and then you know last week uh we find

[00:11:19] ourselves again losing our children this time at a graduation ceremony and not by an accident but by gun violence it would be good i think for us to take a minute to reflect on that and to i mean to the extent we pray to the extent you uh you know whatever you want to do here to reflect upon uh and remember the victims of the shooting at that graduation ceremony for huguenot high school their families and the many others affected by their by the events uh the incident

[00:11:54] was particularly difficult for us you know both the board and the staff at vdoe it occurred not too far from here i don't know how many of you got to see for example the jason cameras the richmond

superintendent and how clearly impacted he was by the events and of course you know everybody who was close into the high school and the greater richmond family so if we could just

[00:12:22] take a moment of remembrance for uh the victims of that event thank you i think it it's good to remember sometimes that we are not alone i ask you to rise now and join me in saying the pledge of allegiance allegiance to the flag of the united states of america and to the republic for which

[00:13:04] indivisible with liberty and justice for all all right uh can i have a motion to approve the minutes for the april 19 and 20 meetings uh the may 10 special meeting and the may 10 emergency meeting of the board as uh had has been distributed by the staff is there a motion to approve those or make amendments thank you miss creasy is there a second thank you mr hanson all those in favor signify by saying hi hi any opposed okay that carries uh dr siebert recognition of state level

[00:13:43] finalists. Good morning, Mr. President, Superintendent Coons, colleagues. It is a wonderful opportunity at our events to celebrate excellence and to really shine a light on the terrific work happening in the Commonwealth. So it's my privilege to share the Presidential Award Recognitions for Excellence in Mathematics and Science Teaching, and these are our state-level finalists. The Virginia Board of Education is pleased to recognize five secondary math of mathematics and science teachers as the 2023 state level finalists for the presidential awards

[00:14:20] for excellence in math and science teaching the paemst this program was established in 1983 is administered by the national science foundation on behalf of the white house office of science and technology the presidential awards for excellence in mathematics and science teaching are the highest honors bestowed by the united states government specifically for k-12 science technology, engineering, mathematics, and/or computer science teaching.

[00:14:46] The program identifies outstanding teachers from each of the 50 states and the four United States jurisdictions. The award recognizes those teachers who have both deep content knowledge of the subjects they teach and the ability to motivate and enable students to be successful in those areas. The awards alternate each year between elementary teachers in kindergarten through sixth grade and secondary teachers in grades seven through 12. The PAMST award serves as models so awardees serve as models for their colleagues and are leaders in the

[00:15:19] improvement of stem education we are honored to recognize the following teachers as the 2023 paemst state level finalists for the commonwealth of virginia um as i speak to you if you come stand up here we'll form a line as we go so our mathematics finalists emily burrell teaches algebra functions and data analysis and algebra 2 at lake at south lakes hill school in reston Virginia. Ms. Burrell sees good in all her students always encouraging them working to get to know them and ensuring that they feel welcome and accepted. She aims not only to understand their story but

[00:15:56] how she can support them in reaching and exceeding their potential. Ms. Burrell is an advocate for underrepresented populations. She strives to work with students to share reflect and promote events and activities that address equity and promote student voice. Ms. Burrell will long be remembered by her students as she sets them up for success not only in mathematics but in life. Ms. Evette Lee is a teacher of computer science coding and economics and personal finance at John Randolph

[00:16:31] Tucker High School in Henrico County. Ms. Lee bodies extensive knowledge drive and commitment to the professor she and her students always seeking to enhance instruction. She searches

out opportunities within as well as beyond her school to ensure that students and the entire student body are prepared for the future. She's played a major role in increasing enrollment in computer science by encouraging students, especially females, to participate in computer science courses and events. She facilitates many of these opportunities herself to ensure that her students take on leadership roles in computer science. Ms. Lee's dedication and hard work

[00:17:07] enable her to touch the lives of each of her students and benefit her school as well as the greater community or Quinn or is the geometry and algebra teacher of seventh and eighth grade students at Jefferson Houston and international baccalaureate school in Alexandria. Ms. Quinn provides daily instruction to middle school students using various instructional practices to engage students in the learning processes and conceptualize math concepts. Ms. Quinn is a reflective educator who creates and shares mathematics lessons that relate to the unique

[00:17:47] experiences of her students. The lessons engage students deeply in mathematics they are learning. as a leader at jefferson houston she serves as a facilitator for the new teachers group facilitating and supporting instructional growth miss quinn is a dynamic teacher who cares and loves for all the students of jefferson houston as is evidenced by the way she interacts and builds relationships and rapport or quinn and now for our science finalists first i'd like to invite colin bouchelon come on up please mr bouchelon is a teacher of biology honors biology and advanced

[00:18:25] placement environmental science at Manassas Park High School in Manassas Park. Mr. Bouchillon engages in students and helps them grow in their excitement about science. He promotes a learning environment where students feel safe to take risks, think out loud, and explore the physical world around them. His love of science and learning has inspired many of the students to pursue their own careers in STEM fields. Mr. Bouchillon brings a deep level of professional knowledge that has allowed him to create and nurture a community of science learners in his classroom and among his

[00:18:56] colleagues throughout the division mr buchelon mr sneller is a teacher of environmental science spanish and honor stem chemistry at harrisonburg high school in harrisonburg he is a teacher who is loved by his students and one who constantly seeks to improve his professional knowledge mr sneller greets all students at the door and focuses their attention on feeling welcome safe and secure in their learning environment mr sneller is a master of asking students questions that promote deep hands-on learning experiences in the worlds of science that are steeped in real

[00:19:36] world applications mr sneller is enthusiastic about exploring and implementing new teaching strategies techniques and sharing these techniques with his colleagues mr sneller the national science foundation oversees the selection of state level awardees and on behalf of the white house we anxiously await hearing about these great educators and who will be recognized as the 2023 awardee for the commonwealth of virginia i'd like to everybody join me in thanking the congratulating these awardees and then we'll do some pictures and some presentations congratulations

[00:20:10] these are important excellent thank you so what we'd like for you to do is come up to the dais we'll get the president to come around and we'll get a picture of you all together so thank

[00:20:43] you welcome nice squeeze in here in the middle don't show what's well in the pictures you think We're the second row. Okay, got it.

[00:21:05] Hold these here. All right, sounds good. That was a science teacher in the early 90s. Paparazzi, who first? The guy in the middle.

[00:21:26] We're wielding. Here we go. All right, thank you. Congratulations.

[00:21:45] Congratulations. thank you

[00:22:21] uh mr president if i may ask for a moment of personal privilege on behalf of my colleagues i would say denied uh we could go through some sort of point of order process but we'll try to avoid that for this very special event um it is not on the agenda but for those of us who have the privilege of serving for some for a long time some for a short time we have uh appreciate immensely the the care and collaboration we appreciate the fact that this is an institution that is in place long before us it will endure long after us and we are just stewards and shepherds of the

[00:22:56] roles we hold i think it's important that we all understand that uh we are individuals and as individuals we have no authority but we gather collectively at legally called board meetings we have great responsibility uh to do what's right for the young people of the commonwealth so we'd like to celebrate some board members today and so i'll start if uh my colleague ann holton would please come forward and share a few remarks and we'll have a little bit of a round robin here and some pictures and maybe some hugs thank you alan i am honored and privileged today to present a

[00:23:33] resolution of appreciation signed by the virginia board of education for dr pamela davis fought some of the current board members have not had the opportunity to get to know pam personally as well as some of the older members she's been suffering from some health issues throughout this year and has been appearing uh remotely but uh i i can tell you uh those of us who have gotten to know her well either through her board service or through her long long dedicated service uh to the children of virginia and especially uh her students in bristol virginia she is a dedicated

[00:24:11] education educator and a lovely human being and it's been a proud opportunity to serve with her in particular she's been a champion of the underserved uh young people in our communities uh title one schools in rural communities and their teachers and educators and communities that serve her and we're grateful for her service so whereas it is with profound respect for her professional and personal accomplishments that the members of the board of education recognize dr pamela davis fought for her distinguished service as a member of this body from july 2019

[00:24:47] until june 2023 and whereas her career as a professional educator has earned her the respect in the communities she has served in southwest and central virginia and her peers throughout the commonwealth and whereas whereas she has served as an unwavering advocate for children and teachers and shown a lifelong commitment to the betterment of the lives of all virginians now therefore be it resolved that the members of the board of education extend to dr dave a spot our valued friend and colleague our highest regards and gratitude for her unfailing service integrity collegiality and the professional manner in which she has performed her duties

[00:25:24] and etc etc signed thank you may we have a round of applause for in bristol mr president do you want to have a motion adopt them as a bank or you want to do them one at a time do them all at once okay all right if it even makes the agenda mr rotherham has our next presentation thank you uh i am want to present a resolution of appreciation uh for dr tammy mann and as ann did i'll read it in just a moment i have you're not supposed to sign things

[00:26:03] before you read them but i admit that i admit that i did um uh i shouldn't say that with lawyers present um uh but i want to thank you for your service uh it's only been you know we only overlapped for a year but sort of you bring i think a very important perspective or a thoughtful perspective and I think you probably noticed the board would pause to listen when you had things to say in our debates. I think it added a lot of value. I'm grateful for that and grateful for your service obviously prior to that as well. Whereas it is with profound respect for her professional and personal accomplishments that the members of the Board of Education recognize Dr. Tammy Mann

[00:26:39] for her distinguished service as a member of this body from July 2019 until June 2023, and whereas Dr. Mann has shown steadfast leadership by serving as vice president of this body from march 2022 until june 2023 and whereas her professional work and research practice and policy has shown a dedication to improving the lives of children and families and earned her the respect and admiration of her peers whereas she has been an unwavering advocate for the transformation of early childhood care and education across the commonwealth thereby contributing to the betterment of the lives of all current and future virginians now therefore be it resolved that the members of

[00:27:16] of the board of education extended dr mann our valued friend and colleague our highest regards and gratitude for her unfailing service integrity collegiality and the professional manner in which she has performed her duties be it further resolved that the members of the board of education extended dr mann our warmest best wishes for continued success in her future endeavors adopted in virginia uh 15th day of june

[00:27:41] all together yes i should be we'll have discussion if assuming we get a motion a second we'll have absolutely special hold a breath for that ms creasy has our next presentation but when i agreed to

[00:28:16] this to to actually help do this this morning i didn't know whether i would um get a little choked up so dan if you will excuse me from getting a little bit emotional um since i came on the board dan has um been a mentor to me and we have grown to become very close friends and i am certainly so thankful for all friends that i can make but especially your friendship dan so um remember i'm

[00:28:50] going to continue to call you so you better pick up that phone but we have a resolution here for you and your um unwavering service to the commonwealth um you and i um have shared on many occasions our deep love for the commonwealth of virginia for the institutions um of this great commonwealth and that is something that will forever bond us so the virginia board of education is presenting to you a resolution of appreciation presented to daniel a gecker member of the

[00:29:29] virginia board of education from 2016 to 2023 whereas it is with profound respect for his professional and personal accomplishments that the members of the board of education recognize Mr. Daniel A. Gecker for his distinguished service as a member of this body from January 2016 until June 2023 and whereas Mr. Gecker has shown extraordinary dedication and steadfast leadership by serving as president of this body from July 2017 until June 2023 and his tenure has been marked

[00:30:05] by a methodical approach to accomplishing the board's priorities and whereas he has led efforts to improve the standards of quality teacher qualifications academic standards and school facilities and thereby earned the respect for his exemplary public service and his contributions will remain a vital importance to public education in the commonwealth and whereas his public service is also marked by a dedication to local leadership including being a member of the chesterfield

[00:30:36] county board of supervisors from 2008 to 2014 and services that body's chairman in 2010 and 2012 as well as numerous other organizations who have benefited from his acumen and thoughtfulness now therefore be it resolved that the members of the board of education extend to mr decker our valued friend and colleague our highest regards and gratitude for his unfailing service integrity collegiality and the professional manner in which he has performed his duties be it further resolved

[00:31:11] that the members of the board of education extend to mr gecker our warmest best wishes for continued success in his future endeavors thank you dan thank you um here's what we're going to do we're going to take these three as a blocks it was our motion to approve the three

[00:31:46] adoption of the three resolutions there there's second thank you somebody uh all in favor say aye any opposed okay uh we are going to table any further discussion because we have a lot of guests in the room and uh you know the guests come first so we will go through public comment and we will have time at the end of the meeting during normal board member comment to say anything you guys want to say he's a bully i lost control of the agenda only for a

[00:32:23] few moments okay uh we will go ahead and do public comment now as always you know the highlight yeah for a lot of us of the meetings is to hear from the public and so it's a pleasure for the board to accept public comment on all matters related to public education in virginia speakers will be recognized in the order in which the request was received speakers are asked to limit their remarks to three minutes when your time is up please close your remarks promptly we ask that you provide your name and affiliation at the beginning of your remarks speakers may provide

[00:32:58] copies of your comments you may email a copy of your remarks to jim chapman excuse me director of board relations after you finish speaking uh you know i look at the list and there's a lot of people who we know uh and you know sad in some ways that it takes public comment to bring emily webb back to visit with us but you are first up on the list i thought you could get away from somebody saying nice things about you but that's not good morning mr president members of the board and dr coons my name is emily webb and i'm pleased to be with you this morning to recognize the service of

[00:33:37] several of your departing board members dr pam davis watt dr tammy mann and president dan gecker i had the pleasure of working closely with each of them during their years of service to the commonwealth and know the impact that they have had on virginia's young people dr davis fought i don't know if she's virtual or not you have brought a wealth of practical classroom experience to this board especially in working with underserved and impoverished populations as a principal your passion for your students and teachers and ensuring they have the resources they need to thrive is unmatched i'll never forget our trip to visit your elementary school in bristol

[00:34:13] Virginia along with several other school divisions in southwest Virginia you could feel the love and respect that they had for you and the love and respect that you had for them you always made sure that your kids had food in their tummy so that they could learn and your teachers had the supplies in their classroom to facilitate that learning you've been a sounding board to me and a valuable and you bring a valuable in the field perspective to this board and it will be missed dr mann you're one of the hardest working most thoughtful individuals i've ever met your early childhood knowledge and expertise is exactly what this board needed when you were appointed you've helped this board tremendously during the transition to oversee all of early

[00:34:52] childhood educational care and have always been able to take complicated topics and distill them down into easy to understand terms you haven't been the loudest or the most talkative person in the room but when you speak everyone listens despite juggling hundreds of balls in the air in your personal and professional life you've always showed up prepared and ready to share a perspective with this board that is unique and valuable to the board's decisions president gecker where to begin i think your time's up mr when you were first appointed to this board i was sitting in the audience and had no idea that in just a few short months we would be working together so

[00:35:30] closely as board president you had big shoes to fill in succeeding dr billy canaday and boy have you filled those shoes and then some you have pushed this board to be better you have focused this board on thoughtful collaborative evidence-based policy making you've took time away from your work and your family to ensure that this board succeeded that it heard the perspectives of all the education stakeholders and that every decision that was made was made in the best interest of virginia's children you have led this board with the utmost professionalism and integrity i'd like to say thank you to your wife liz and daughters number one through four and their

[00:36:07] families for learning you to us for all these years i'm immensely grateful for your mentorship and the friendship we've built over the last seven years you have challenged me and frustrated me to be better to think outside the box and to always do my research i know you say you aren't an educator but you have taught us so much as president gecker always says this is the hardest working board in the commonwealth and i couldn't agree more the work this boards undertakes is of the utmost importance and has lasting effects on students and educators across the commonwealth while there's still work to be done i pray that the collaborative transparent students first

[00:36:46] mindset that this board remains at the forefront of all decision making to come to pam to tammy in to Dan thank you you have made a difference thank you all right uh Scott Braebrand followed by Emily Klein good morning Scott Braebrand executive director for VAS dear superintendent Coons and members of the board of education first I want to thank Dr Coons for her meeting and

[00:37:20] listening to school superintendents as she begins her tenure as Virginia's new state superintendent her personal outreach these past few weeks to each VDOE superintendent region to listen to our feedback on Virginia's current accreditation accountability system and our ideas for improvement as you all consider changes to this current system is greatly appreciated. We continue to look forward to continued collaboration with her on this issue and many other issues of mutual interest. We also want to share with you that as you review the math standards we remind you just as we did during social studies standards review that you follow standard protocols and

[00:37:59] procedures to ensure extensive stakeholder input with special attention to listening to those who have subject matter expertise and take a particular look at the elementary level and the multiple initiatives before our elementary educators. VAS also encourages this board as you're currently doing at this meeting today to continue to review multiple pathways of licensure for teachers and to listen to school districts as they step forward and offer ideas about how to ensure a highly qualified teacher in every Virginia classroom, something Dr. Koons has already talked about extensively in her short tenure with us. We continue to have a teacher shortage in the

[00:38:37] Commonwealth of Virginia that we must collectively address through a variety of strategies. Finally, I too, as Executive Director of VASS and a former superintendent in two districts in Virginia, want

to thank Pamela Davis Vaught for her work and leadership. She was a voice for those who often didn't feel they had a voice in the Commonwealth. I want to thank Tammy Mann for being a champion for equity and excellence here in the commonwealth you always understood the details but you also got the bigger picture thank you for your leadership and president gecker you led in the best of times in the commonwealth and for some maybe they would say the worst of times

[00:39:13] but you were a model of integrity a model of professionalism and you always in a world right now where people want to divide some some people want to divide you were a leader who wanted to bring people together for the common benefit of public education for virginia's children you are a true champion a model leader for this board and a model leader in the commonwealth thank you for your service i'm a native virginian and i thank you for your service to the commonwealth

[00:39:42] of virginia thank you thank you okay emily klein followed by paul fanny emily klein uh paul fanny

[00:39:56] okay uh wendy little greetings board members oh can you hear me greetings board members uh welcome

[00:40:37] miss coons um you were a rock star last night we need you my name is wendy little i'm with chesterfield county schools this child here has had no education access to education all year his name is aaron little how many times do people from chesterfield county have to keep coming over and over and over for years and and go to this board and tell you about the problems that are

[00:41:10] having in chesterfield county i would like you to i would like you to consider invoking somebody has to take a stand and do something about the injustices to our families and our children i encourage you to invoke policy 22.1-214e upon chesterfield county public schools for the egregious manner in which they teach treat our children and many of our families it has to stop i have some packets for you one packet is a in the first page includes a letter from winsome sears

[00:41:48] talking about the treatment of my son from chesterfield county public schools a year ago there's nobody who has helped me the second the second page is a letter from one of my son's case managers that outliers loss of his developmental disability waiver benefits because chesterfield county public schools would not allow him to go to his public education followed by thank you for allowing input copy of my input for yesterday's work session again you were a rock star you nailed My input from February 2nd, which I couldn't come, but I put some very clear input in that.

[00:42:27] And also another input, I was the only person in the entire state of Virginia who was invited to and attended a USDOE pandemic special education roundtable beginning in May 2021. Do you know who got all of the IDEA funding for the special needs kids? You're looking at it right now. I did that.

[00:42:44] I also, because our kids were not being educated for recovery of learning, I did that. y'all can foyer it also i said sr3 is the biggest package coming up i want to see a percentage of that go to recovery of learning overall our school divisions did not do that this is why i made signs like this so i will leave my written input for you i made these signs because being on that committee fund special education students now they were supposed to provide services for these kids to for to uh to not have recovery of learning be quite an issue thank goodness the governor came in what did he do he did what they were supposed to do supported the low income and the special

[00:43:22] needs kids priority one for services and grants that go directly to services they should have gotten with the money that i got for the entire usa every county that was me so i've been on top of this and i've been very angry i implore you to please invoke policy 221214e stop starving our special education children my son has had no access to public education the entire year i have written the board i have begged leadership at chesterfield county public schools they ignore me my other son is a cdg student that's center-based gifted and the same the school that he's assigned that we're

[00:44:02] all assigned to by residents my special needs son supposed to be at the same school my other school has great attendance but they're trying to tell me they won't i won't send my child to school my child to school he requires special education transportation i got an email they were going to send him at the beginning of the year then i get an email that says nope and i've been fighting this battle by all year so we something has to happen and the parents are angry and we're very upset and and we're very upset and and things do need to turn around and i thank you for your commentary because i've never heard anything like that from anyone before we need to stop denying the rights and needs of special education students some of these will be some of the school divisions are

[00:44:40] going to have to return those funds thank you for your time thank you miss lucas followed by kathy halverson until emily her time was up anyway my name is candace lucas i am an advocate i'm also uh shocked by the comment that was made but pleasantly shocked by the comment that was made regarding special education being broken in virginia thank you for the validation

[00:45:19] thank you for the transparency because evidently samantha and dr coons don't believe it's broken or else they will be addressing it special education right now is at stage four cancer and you guys are giving them a baby aspirin think about that and i want to let this board know that you were bamboozled you were hoodwinked you were led astray yesterday and i'm telling you why the presentation that samantha gave you that dr coons allowed did not address the fact that that they received a letter on February 17th, 2023

[00:46:00] that told them, Jim and Samantha, if you don't get yourself together from OSAP, we're gonna take your federal funding for special education. She didn't say that to you, but guess what? I bought a copy for you.

[00:46:15] I bought a copy of the letter for you. So you can understand we're in a crisis. The ones that are leaving, please don't take one. I couldn't make many copies. Okay, the bottom line is that she left that out. She left that out on purpose. Samantha needs to be terminated.

[00:46:32] She doesn't even have a valid administrative license. They gave her a courtesy one so she could come in and screw up the lives of our children. She has committed perjury regarding children. She has stolen money regarding children. And you move her to the office below you?

[00:46:49] You should have moved her out. Dr. Coons, you knew about this life. you let samantha present that mess yesterday which blew up my phone when i was working you let samantha present this without telling the board that we're going to lose our funding because you guys can't get it right that was completely irresponsible and samantha needs to be removed i'm going to give you as samantha asked for some grace because you're not giving our kids grace this needs to be fixed now it's broken it's broken and how do you expect the

[00:47:29] people that broke it to fix it how do you expect the people that profit from it being broken to fix it it's not going to happen this is a civil rights issue this is a civil rights issue as a black woman i am outraged you want to know what's going on with the hearing officers sir hearing officers are sitting up in blake and shipping keith's office conducting hearings at their leisure hearing officers are putting in their rulings that me as an advocate i'm not a black woman as i purport i'm of mixed race what does that have to do with the hearing but they're so biased and so

[00:48:05] toxic that they don't give our parents their rights and for the record you want it uh sir you wanted information as to the the information that you need for special education this is the book that we that's sitting up in a closet in the videoe that nobody gives out i get 100 of these and give them out to parents and put them out in libraries.

[00:48:27] Parents take these to IEP meetings and when they try to ask the questions in this book, we get called, the police called on us. We get called disruptive. We get called, we get told that we are not being collaborative and cooperative.

[00:48:43] When we ask these questions that we're told to ask, Dr. Combs, you're new. Don't screw up this opportunity to fix it. Get rid of Samantha and don't cover it up anymore. She would tell this matter. If we find out through FOIA requests that you knew, we're going to demand your resignation as well.

[00:49:04] Thank you, Ms. Lucas. Kathy Halverson, followed by Terrence Walker.

[00:49:22] Good morning, Board. I'm back again this month about my son in Powhatan County. Last time I was here two months ago, I shared, and Mr. Hanson, I want to say thank you.

[00:49:39] You're the only one that has brought up about the funding. I had mentioned last time Powhatan County is over 730% of the legal budget, which I've included in your handouts.

[00:49:54] And it's all coming from special education improvement of instruction right here. I FOIAed the ESSER money. You also have a copy of this.

[00:50:11] Grant number two and three. Tell me, how is legal services a nice even amount? $75,000 from grants two and three ESSER money. It's being misallocated.

[00:50:28] I have told everybody this over and over. It's misallocation. Powhatan County has spent close to $1.5 million dollars in legal fees in two years. They state they cannot provide a contract for private placement on page 30. It states private placements. They're denying my son. He has not been in a school since November 10th of 2021. He went to Believe in You Academy. Transition was amazing. You need

[00:51:04] to do 22.1-214 number E. The BDOE has the right. If I have done everything I need it to do, you need to hold Powhatan County's funding and send my son to school. So back to my son. I've been here. I've stated how gifted he was. The school stated he was not gifted because they did not want to give him a one-on-one we learned during an annual imp meeting because they are receiving federal funding every year even though they are not

[00:51:42] educating him i foiled because they unenrolled him you've also got this up top alert gifted and right here it doesn't say unenrolled they have my son as a fourth grade dropout when have you heard of a gifted student being a fourth grade dropout this is retaliation right here my son cries at

[00:52:15] night i finally because i was denied an iee went to dr ronald federici he has got post-traumatic stress syndrome from being restrained and turning blue he's also been denied education since

kindergarten since kindergarten it's dr federici which you have has stated educational neglect since kindergarten he has not been given services all this time so send a contract he he

[00:52:54] stated he needed to be at believe in you academy six weeks ago we've got in touch with the school no urgency nothing as he's got severe regression when are you going to do something thank you terrence walker followed by shakita brown terrence walker uh shakita brown

[00:53:37] cheryl sims tammy c anything good morning morning so mrs coons i would like to start by thanking you for making the staff respond to emails that is a baby step in the right direction hank has become one-on-one in email um between my son so i spoke once before my son is 19 and he has done the same

[00:54:15] curriculum for three years trying to achieve a GED. We want to try something different as they have brought no new ideas to the table. We want to give him Foster a try. Their brilliant idea was to put him in the ninth grade class with 14 year olds. Wouldn't that just go over great with some Powtan parents? I thought about coming up here and being completely silent. Then I thought no, I refuse to step down to their level however that is what one of our IEPs are like because they run

[00:54:54] they're run by Sands Anderson law firm telling them what to say and most of the time it's nothing that makes an IEP meaningful our IEPs are limited to one hour per the law firm and most of the hour is in silence so they can prolong the delay and deny tactic if any of you would like to be included in the next IEP, you can get my email from Hank. He has it. Then perhaps if you sit in on a couple IEPs secretly under a different name, you can see firsthand how the IEP team isn't doing their job.

[00:55:31] Now, let's talk about Alex, Ms. Halverson's son. I watch him. He's a brilliant 11-year-old. You know, when I was his age, I would have loved to have been home for two years with no education because i hated getting up early and i dislike school however this young boy needs you to step up to the plate i watched him create ways to include math and minecraft and other video games he yearns for math absolutely loves it to be in being you academy for two weeks and then pulled out stating

[00:56:08] no payment he has enough to worry about with his disabilities he hears absolutely everything so So with that being said, he probably is wondering what he did wrong that no one wants to educate him, or if he isn't good enough to be educated.

[00:56:26] Like this, like his mother said, he cries at night to be in BAU Academy, and sometimes on me during the day when I watch him. I truly want to say, well, Alex, this is Virginia education for you, but I will not. I will withhold that.

[00:56:45] I mean, his mother has spoken up here for over a year. When are you going to handle the positions that you took under oath? Justice for all SPED kids and parents. Keep fighting. If you want to speak, it's once a month, sign up and share your story or anything in regards to public education in Virginia.

[00:57:09] Thank you. - Thank you. David Woodard followed by Diane Huber.

[00:57:30] - Morning, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, members of the Virginia Board of Education, Dr. Kunz. My name is David Woodard. I'm president of the Virginia School Board Association. It's my privilege to address you today on behalf of the 800 plus school board members who proudly serve their communities across our Commonwealth.

[00:57:51] At previous meetings, the board has devoted considerable discussion to Virginia's accountability and accreditation models. VSBA strongly believes in the importance of holding school divisions accountable the education outcomes of students. We support an accountability system that utilizes the standards of learning to measure student achievement with the inclusion of state-approved authentic measures of student growth over time. We encourage the board to include VSBA's input and any final product

[00:58:25] because as stakeholders with constitutional powers to run local school division operations, school board members will have the responsibility of informing and explaining the new system to the parents and interested parties in their communities in this past session of the virginia general assembly lawmakers passed senate bill 1124 and senate bill 1215 respectively these bills require the formation of working groups to look at two long-standing vsba positions of support for the board of education to address school construction and maintenance

[00:59:01] and the soq and appropriate appropriate compensation of teachers of the commonwealth the sba supported both the pieces of legislation so hopes to have an opportunity to be a part of this conversation for the past two years we have heard from the current administration the desire for collaboration and partnership as one of the largest associations representing public servants who have the constitutional responsibility to operate public schools We stand ready to partner and collaborate to build stronger, more vibrant schools systems

[00:59:38] that are accountable to our parents, our communities, and all our citizens with a vested interest in the future. However, we are disappointed that calls for collaboration and partnerships seem to be just words lacking follow-through and action. BSBA will continue to advocate for policies that lead to strong public schools and remains hopeful that calls for partnership and collaboration will include us with a seat at the table. Finally, I'd like to offer VSBA's appreciation to President

[01:00:10] Goethe, Vice President Mann, and Virginia board member Davis Valt for your service on the Virginia Board of Education. VSBA appreciates your partnership and we have had with you in your tenure on the board and looks forward to working with current board members as well as developing relationships with the new appointees to the board once they're nominated by gatherer yanka i thank you for your time today and for all you do on behalf of public education in the commonwealth

[01:00:41] thank you diane huber followed by wendy amato morning good morning president geckhert members of the board and superintendent koontz i'm dr diane huber the founder of i teach and i'm here speaking on item c 20 years ago while working at a large state institution in teacher preparation

[01:01:13] i wondered why it was so expensive for teachers for individuals to become teachers and it was a financial barrier to keep people out of our wonderful profession i founded i teach to remove that financial barrier some in the education arena thought that the low cost of i teach meant low standards low quality and teacher preparation nothing was further from the truth i wanted to offer assurances to our applicants and to our school districts that we met or exceeded

[01:01:52] the high standards set by institutions of higher ed in 2009 i teach became the first and currently the only non-institution of higher education to obtain CAPE accreditation. We maintain that accreditation today and our next site visit is scheduled for 2027. Through working with CAPE for almost 15 years, ITH is focused on the continued review of our curriculum and programs

[01:02:27] components to ensure complete alignment with the most recent research on instruction and learning, legislative mandates and best practices of supporting novice teachers through district division collaboration the division applications before you today are premier examples of a true division epp collaborative with both entities working together side by side to prepare

[01:03:02] high quality teachers. iTeach will deliver the curriculum and the districts will deliver the mentoring and induction components of teacher certification. Oftentimes in today's world, more time is spent on criticizing the solution to the problem than focusing on the problem.

[01:03:22] The board has reviewed two 2021 studies on teacher preparation in Texas. I would like to give you two examples of the great work iTeach is doing right now close to your home.

[01:03:40] iTeach was selected by Dr. Carla Warren, Assistant Superintendent in West Virginia, to work with 180 paraprofessionals to take them to certification. Additionally, iTeach has been identified by Dr. Rebecca Estes, Assistant Sup in Indiana, to collaborate on STEM.

[01:04:01] we ask you to approve the applications before you without any conditions thank you thank you wendy amato followed by mo gaffney president gecker dr goons and board members my name is dr wendy amato i'm speaking on agenda item c i have the distinct privilege to continue advancing educational standards and expectations as our organization's chief academic officer my office

[01:04:39] is in charlottesville i began teaching in 1991 and have spent the last 30 plus years of my career engaged in education i started as a teacher became an administrator i've been responsible for recruitment and retention my experience became my commitment to supporting educators it also informed my graduate and postgraduate studies i earned my master's of education from the university of virginia focusing on language acquisition i then completed my phd from the University of Virginia in Curriculum and Instruction. Since 2009, I've had the joy of being employed by

[01:05:16] UVA as an instructor in the School of Education. I'm currently teaching two courses: World Language Teaching Methods and Cross-Cultural Education for Diverse Learners. I frequently teach a specific section for a cohort out of Alexandria. My resume shows that I'm embedded in the formal education system of Virginia, but that's just a sliver of my story and only part of the explanation for my continued desire to make virginia public schools the best what won't appear on my resume or teaching accomplishments is that i live and breathe the fruit of the virginia education system

[01:05:55] when i encounter young students on grounds downtown or in my neighborhood i get to call virginia home my husband and i registered our only child for kindergarten in our city schools and we watched her graduate in state from william and mary the importance of quality education is never far from my mind or vision or action. I have confidence in the efforts of this board in putting forth all what we need for the next generation's education. I'm personally invested in similar work to ensure that high quality training is available for any aspiring new teacher.

[01:06:33] As my organization's chief academic officer, I'm responsible for holding rigorous training as a non-negotiable. I'm proud to work closely with Dr. Amy Anderson and our curriculum team to produce some of the strongest content available, while also keeping it accessible.

[01:06:54] Earning CAPE accreditation has been a crowning achievement, but I do not allow that achievement to bring complacency. We all know curriculum improvement continues through program reflection, continuous improvement practices, current research, alignment with state standards, and

attentiveness to state requirements, non-negotiable. I share the Commonwealth's high standards and high expectations, and I'm working here right alongside the divisions on behalf of our students to help our state's educators.

[01:07:28] I respectfully ask that you approve these divisions applications with no conditions. Thank you. - Thank you. Mo Gaffney followed by Amy Anderson.

[01:07:50] - Good morning, Dr. Koons, President Gecker, and board members. My name is Dr. Mo Gaffney, and I'm a Charlottesville native. I have taught in public school and private school in Charlottesville, both Charlottesville and Albemarle County schools.

[01:08:05] And I'm also taught at the University of Virginia. Today I'm speaking on agenda item C, as you probably guessed. I have most recently served as a principal for 11 years, and I firsthand experienced the teacher shortage for elementary teachers and how difficult that was.

[01:08:28] Currently in my role, am the mid-atlantic regional director of iTeach and since august i have met in virginia with over 50 divisions to share about iTeach based on house bill 2486 and i have covered every part of virginia including bristol um today several of the divisions are here and they will share with you their specific needs and i have shared with you their letters some of them you saw last time and some are new and they wanted me to represent them consistent with national trends as you know

[01:09:04] in virginia we are experiencing the teacher shortage governor youngkin's executive directive number three addresses the crisis stating that one of his administrators administration's top priorities is to ensure that every classroom in virginia has great teachers i teach can help reduce the red tape associated with teacher licensure and can provide high quality teachers in every classroom in Virginia. I have partnered with the 22 I teach division applications before

[01:09:40] you today. As you know they have numerous teachers on provisional license and were not able to fill several of their vacancies this school year and are experiencing the same challenges for next year. these divisions boards and superintendents have partnered with iTeach to offer a CAPE accredited alternative certification option passing the praxis is a challenge for many of these folks wanting to become teachers and iTeach offers a start of the state of the art passage preparation

[01:10:16] a test preparation tool that will help teachers prepare and pass the test you have heard from the divisions in their applications and letters and you'll hear from some today that iTeach is cost effective and time effective way to get teachers license without lowering the academic standards iTeach is equitable and allowing a more affordable option for licensure in closing i'm asking on behalf of the children in Virginia that you would approve iTeach with no conditions thank you for

[01:10:52] your service and thank you for letting allowing us to speak today uh amy anderson followed by andrew roselle good morning mr president gecker members of the board and superintendent coons my name is amy anderson i am the director of curriculum and instruction for i teach it is my pleasure to speak with you today regarding the i teach curriculum alignment to virginia standards of learning with special attention to address the feedback from item k

[01:11:29] the first review of divisions partnering with the iTeach application document. The iTeach professional courses are in-task aligned and CAPE accredited. Extensive work was completed to align the Virginia standards of learning to the professional iTeach courses and provide a foundation of knowledge on which the ancillary courses build upon.

[01:11:49] A detailed document has been provided to you that shares the alignment of iTeach courses to the Virginia administrative code. We are happy to provide continuous competency assurances by the Department of Education, as mentioned by Superintendent Koons yesterday. The iTeach curriculum is rigorous. Facilitated through Canvas our learning management system, educator candidates learn best practices of teaching and learning through the application of Virginia Standards of Learning to the course assignments. For example, educator candidates set goals, demonstrate comprehension, create lesson plans, evaluate strategies, and reflect on their own practice.

[01:12:27] These learning experiences are applied in their placement, in turn supports the development of content pedagogical knowledge i teach virginia educator candidates are granted full video subscription to access the teaching channel which includes approximately 1500 exemplary videos many of which are included in the courses the courses are facilitated by qualified instructors who support educator candidates through constructive feedback aligned to rubrics on submitted assignments and correspondence until sufficient evidence of mastery is met as a result the course experience

[01:13:03] and level of mastery are exceptionally consistent i teach is committed to program improvement addressing president gecker's concerns expressed yesterday yes we are for profit but we are more importantly for students for teachers and for you the commonwealth i'm a former eighth grade math and algebra one teacher then i was a math instructional coach and then an administrator i understand firsthand how amazing teachers hearts are and how important adequate training is we do not take this responsibility lightly responding to new research and the changing

[01:13:38] landscape of education is essential to ensuring educator candidates are prepared with current trends for student success our course committees that include subject matter experts course developers and course instructors meet quarterly to review course materials trends and submissions and course correspondence the collaborative efforts of the course committees influence course improvements. Additionally, educator candidates complete end-of-course surveys that are used to inform course improvements. Program improvement is continuous. IT is responsive to

[01:14:13] progressive changes in standards and in response coursework is expeditiously revised to align to new standards as they become approved. Similar work has recently been completed to align courses in Florida to their new standards of learning. It's our intent to provide an efficient and comprehensive pathway for educator candidates to satisfy the requirements and competencies approved by the virginia department of education so that teachers across the commonwealth have the access to high quality affordable flexible and efficient your comments thank you so much for your time i

[01:14:44] hope you have a lovely day thank you uh Andrew rosell followed by jeremy bennett morning good to see you again superintendent coons president gecker and members of the board i'm here speaking on item c iTeach has been training teachers for over 20 years the impetus for our creation was to provide an affordable and accessible route to high quality training this remains true 20 years later i'm confident that the quality of our training and the reputation we've built is the reason we are the identified partner in the 22 applications before you as stated in the board's

[01:15:22] second priority the board is to quote advance policies that increase the number of candidates entering the teaching profession and encourage and support the recruitment development and retention of well-prepared and skilled teachers and school leaders recently i had an individual apply to our program for a job and when i was reading the resume it's so aligned to the job description i felt that they wrote their

resume in response to the job posting in a strange way i feel similar about the 20 year old mission of i teach aligned so well with the priorities of this board the alignment is strikingly similar yesterday concern was brought up in work session regarding our sole

[01:15:59] source language and sort of partnership agreements i wanted to say that many large districts that have had access to and completed the legal process have kept the language as drafted in mou some of these districts and divisions include loudon arlinson and riko the isle of right and others however based on the feedback yesterday i'm willing to re-engage with each of our partners to discuss modifications to language if necessary or reconfirm the agreement of such language yesterday we spoke about uh i teach being an option and travis holder from fairfax called us

[01:16:34] a menu item and in line with that we certainly want to keep options available if the other options are of similar quality and also cape accredited i believe that one of the reasons that virginia has so many provisionally licensed teachers as noted by ann holton in the april meeting is that a true alternative to higher education does not exist with that i'm confident that because higher ed is the primary option many teachers are not making the needed financial or time commitment to complete their licensure at a college many already have a degree and are not seeking another degree or more college credit iTeach provides accessible rigorous and affordable training for teachers it can help lessen the number of provisional teachers as well

[01:17:13] as help recruit new teachers to the profession if the board includes conditions on the division applications where teachers are still required to complete college coursework we thereby provide them the same option they currently have as you've heard from dr huber and dr anderson we pride ourselves in our quality instruction and have earned the same earned the same approval as many of the universities here in Virginia, some of which UVA, James Madison, William & Mary, VCU, and the University of Richmond are all Cape Accredited Institutes. As provided in the supplemental packet requested by the board, we articulated how our courses meet and even exceed the requirements

[01:17:49] of the application conditions articulated in April. Also in the packet we demonstrate that Nevada requires methods courses just like Virginia, except in Nevada those courses can be completed at a university or i teach we are confident in the content and quality of our application and of our program we are proud to have helped 20 000 individuals find fulfilling careers and educations and we're proud that the new teacher of the year in las vegas the fifth largest school district was an it's completer we are seeking to earn the approval of this mid application with no additional conditions placed so we can partner with the efforts of the department with the board

[01:18:25] to achieve a mutual goal provide every student with a highly effective well-trained teacher thank you thank you uh jeremy bennett followed by delphine jumpy morning president gecker members of the board uh superintendent koons my name is jeremy bennett representing the virginia association of counties vaco uh before i get into the meat of my uh remarks just wanted to say thank you uh to uh miss davis fought dr man president gecker uh for all your service and leadership on

[01:19:01] issues of education um you know particularly dr man your your leadership in early childhood matters and uh president gecker certainly uh since i've been in education policy you've been a feature of this board so appreciate your leadership and your accessibility um i mean come here today to talk about two pieces of legislation that the general assembly uh passed this past session uh specifically sb 1215 and sb 1124 as you may be aware the former requires the department of education to convene a stakeholder

work group uh no later than august of this year to consider make recommendations on the appropriateness feasibility potential fiscal impact and potential unintended consequences of

[01:19:39] certain definitions for and calculations of competitive teacher pay the latter bill requires the board of education to make recommendations to the general assembly for amendments to these standards of quality to establish standards for the maintenance and operations renovation and new construction of public and secondary school buildings the bill requires the board to solicit input of relevant stakeholders and the public in developing such recommendations VACO respectfully asked that the department consider and that we have our seat at the table for both of these work groups and studies both the teacher compensation work group and the school construction standards both issues are of great concern and importance to local governments as i'm sure

[01:20:17] you're aware local governments are the majority funding partners in the commonwealth when it comes to k-12 public education and they do so to the tune of 4.2 billion dollars more than that requires you under the required local effort so though we are thankful for the recent actions of the general assembly to provide additional funding for teacher compensation and we're supportive of virginia reaching the national average for compensation as you're aware when the state proposes teacher salary increases local governments not only have to provide the local share to access state funds for soq positions but also the full share for all other positions that are that are currently currently employed so additionally we are very appreciative of the 1.25 billion dollars

[01:20:57] appropriated by the general assembly for school construction renovation uh however as you're aware of the total cost to fully replace or renovate schools in virginia is approaching 25 billion um and you know we're appreciative that appreciative of those funds being put forward but until last year that cost has been solely funded by local governments across the commonwealth so you know for these reasons we respect the request to be a part of these conversations going forward and in conclusion uh veto appreciates the work of the board of education we stand by to be ready partners in these efforts and make sure the students in Virginia have access and opportunities for the best education possible so thank you for your time and consideration

[01:21:34] Delphine Joppy followed by Tony Childress good morning good morning good morning Mr. President members of the board Dr. Coons I'm Delphine Joppy I serve as superintendent for Charles City County Public Schools and as you know the teacher shortage has impacted schools and school districts across our nation and this shortage deeply impacts small and rural school divisions like charles city county and in schools where there's high need i appreciate the efforts our state has made to address the issue such as looking at critical shortage teaching endorsement

[01:22:09] areas working with vrs and determining candidate eligibility for the virginia teaching scholarship loan program and the development of the recruitment and retention advisory committee with representatives from key stakeholders across all eight superintendent regions the team worked diligently to develop a strategic plan called turning the tide addressing the educator shortage in virginia and that plan has three overarching goals reducing barriers for qualified individuals to enter the profession increasing the number of candidates eligible to build public schools

[01:22:49] and for us that's the areas of special education mathematics science and cte and that third goal is strengthening strategies to recruit and retain a diverse highly qualified educator workforce iTeach would support these goals and we support iTeach as an alternative teacher certification program just as

another route another path if you will to addressing the teacher shortage they have in an innovative approach to alternative teacher certification working to develop the next generation of educators through an intentional combination of coursework exams and hands-on

[01:23:25] field experience and if our division was fortunate to receive educators via this path they would receive the mentorship that we provide to all new educators new to the division new to the profession and they would also receive all relevant ongoing professional development thank you thank you tony childress followed by ann tatis good morning members of the board superintendent dr coons and guests i'd like to begin by thanking the board and the eoe for thinking

[01:24:00] outside of the box to assist school divisions within the commonwealth with this teacher shortage my name is dr tony childress supervisor of hr for a small division charles city public schools as my superintendent dr jaffe stated our small rural division has a high need for quality teachers we believe i teach fits our division's high standards for teachers what we have in our division are college graduates and long-term substitutes who want to become teachers these are graduates and substitutes for many walks of life but who want to teach in our schools these

[01:24:38] individuals are vested in the division they are graduates of charles city community members parents young substitutes who have found their passion in teaching while substituting these are the individuals we want to capture through an alternate route to licensure with high standards like i teach in addition i teach fits into our current division mentorship program that involves one-on-one weekly meetings with administration and mentors consistent weekly plc meetings with other grade level teachers and monthly meetings with our division mentorship program fortunately our

[01:25:13] schools are already practicing plc's which foster conversations around data and instruction while also providing support new teachers benefit from our plc's because they meet weekly and have discussions regarding the instructional practice practices and research-based strategies important to the overall instructional program secondly a supportive measure our principals employees the weekly meetings with new teachers this provides one-on-one uninterrupted time to discuss concerns and needs with an administrator this works really well with our walkthroughs our division

[01:25:48] administrators conduct regularly providing feedback to teachers and discussing how to improve student engagement and learning thirdly our division assigns seasoned mentor teachers to all new teachers this allows for quick questions that new teachers may have regarding practices procedures or anything else these relationships are valuable to a new teacher and must be nurtured throughout the year our teacher mentors and new teachers meet monthly as a group with division leaders and individually to discuss specific needs our goal is to support our new teachers with seasoned teachers administrators and specialists so that there are no questions

[01:26:27] that ever go unanswered and we have the very best in front of our students it is our mission to increase the number of qualified candidates entering the teacher profession i ask that you approve i teach with no conditions thank you thank you and tatis followed by akita manizade

[01:26:48] see miss tatis it's agita manizade here chris jones good morning president gecker vice president mann members of the board superintendent koontz my name is dr chris jones and i'm the executive director for the virginia affiliate of asd this morning i'm also wearing three other hats those of the former high school principal of a diverse student body of just over 2500 students a math

[01:27:24] teacher and father of four of virginia's public school students it is an honor and a privilege to stand before you today i would like to commend superintendent coons for her willingness to collaborate engage the organizations that support virginia's students families and educators and to take time to listen and learn during her entry we recognize your hard work and appreciate your approach i'm here to speak briefly regarding the revised math standards we appreciate the thorough and collaborative process that involved the stakeholders across the commonwealth to create a draft of standards that are aligned to the needs of Virginia students within the standards we see the potential for deeper learning implementation of the five c's and durable skills incorporation of

[01:28:02] nctm's process standards context-based learning and embedding the 17 career clusters opportunities for interdisciplinary connections a greater vertical alignment with connections across the standards and an increase in data collection and analysis i am hopeful that we can use what we learned from the missteps in the process during the revision of the history and social science standards we can and should trust tina mazikane and her team finally i would like to raise a concern about the updated timeline proposed which differs significantly from the one approved by the board of january 2022. the timeline included a development year to finalize a framework gather

[01:28:39] and share resources provide professional learning for teachers and create assessment items for summative benchmark and achievement tests the timeline included a crosswalk year to make the transition as smooth as possible for students families and classroom teachers 2025-26 was designated as the full implementation year by removing the development year and jumping straight to a crosswalk year we are putting an unnecessary strain on students and families teachers school and division support staff and the system itself it is also worth noting that we are in the summer months and crosswalk implementation beginning after the school year has started is detrimental to the success of teaching and learning students on a four by four calendar and students in

[01:29:19] accelerated math classes would feel a significant impact of the decision to remove the development year we should not rush implementation for the reasons the original timeline was developed and i would underscore that now amidst a staffing shortage teacher burnout student mental health crisis and initiative over saturation would not be a time to accelerate the timeline and change what was approved by the board i urge you to spend sufficient time contemplating the impact such an accelerated timeline will have on our students and their families our classroom teachers and our school and division leaders throughout the commonwealth finally i would like to show

[01:29:54] appreciation and gratitude to president gecker dr mann and dr davis vaut for your years of service on this board and to virginia students your leadership advocacy and courage are inspiring and will be missed thank you thank you uh laura estes followed by ellen burnett morning school board members and superintendent coons i'm speaking on behalf of the prince george county public schools as the chief human resources officer what i implore you to keep in mind today

[01:30:29] as you take action on alternate route applications for us to partner with i teach is the context for our request imagine a school division with over half of 500 teaching faculty with less than five years teaching experience including 50 provisional teachers and 31 international teachers with a limited three-year visitation cycle add in 40 unfilled vacancies not including the many unfilled specialized positions that we have with the use of over 30 subcontracted special education

[01:31:04] resource providers and you have just part of the context that we face in real time today in prince george this creates one of the most challenging errors in education i have seen in my 30 years and it threatens our goals for providing a quality education for all students i can attest that we are doing everything we can to address this but we need you to support our efforts with this option we have held monthly job site on on-site job fairs attended many college fairs as we can constantly engaged in social media campaigns offer sign-on bonuses critical shortage stipends

[01:31:41] increased tuition reimbursement visited college and university campuses to recruit on-site created our own future teacher pipeline with our high school students using teach for tomorrow student internships and we are pre-offering employment to these students for four years from now to come back and teach with us it's incredible we have overhauled our recognition programs raise salaries and implemented as many options as we can to create the optimal environment for our teachers to work in it is vital that we expand licensure routes and use innovative options available to us to rebuild the teaching workforce we have structures in place for

[01:32:20] new teachers we have teacher academies we have mentor teacher programs professional development and we will continue to do all that we can to support and retain those entering the teaching profession but we are asking for your help now to approve this additional path for us to increase our pool of candidates and offer another path to becoming a teacher our context does not permit us to delay finding solutions we are excited i want to say that we are excited about iTeach and the opportunity that it creates for us to find new candidates and help them move forward becoming teachers so we ask that you please move forward with supporting this option for us and we thank

[01:32:59] Thank you for your leadership and your work. - Ellen Burnett, Courtney Baker. Ellen Burnett, Courtney Baker.

[01:33:20] Okay, I'm sorry. - Yes. - Thank you. Sorry, I can't see around that corner. So fortunately, Dr. Mann can, she's coming, be quiet now. - Thank you. - All right.

[01:33:37] Good morning, honorable chairman, esteemed members, the Virginia School Board of Education and Superintendent Coons. Thank you for allowing me the opportunity to address you today. My name is Dr. Courtney Baker. associate professor of mathematics education at george mason university and director of the mathematics education center there yesterday you heard about the five areas of focus that guided the 2023 mathematics standing of learning standards of learning revisions i stand before you today to first share data that explains why the five areas of focus are a necessary shift and second present an information guide that illuminates the research behind the five areas of focus currently virginia

[01:34:13] students are barely performing above the national average in mathematics after k-12 schooling many students struggle in college-level mathematics because of incomplete and insecure understandings these data are problematic because mathematics is the core of countless disciplines and industries and integral to the everyday experiences of adults in the united states regardless of career fortunately there is a solution research consistently shows that students who develop a deep understanding of mathematical concepts outperform their peers who solely rely on memorization and rope problems thus i present an eight-page information guide endorsed by four

[01:34:50] virginia organizations with representation of k-12 educators and higher education faculty across all eight regions of virginia this information packet illuminates the research informed areas of focus that have guided the 2023 mathematics standards of learning revisions it draws on

recommendations by the national council of teachers of mathematics and the national assessment of educational progress that define the math content and thinking skills students need to pursue a full range of college and career opportunities and most importantly the areas of focus align with the state initiatives to promote high expectations and excellence for

[01:35:26] all students improving vertical articulation equips our students with the necessary foundation for higher-level mathematics courses and future STEM-related careers. Incorporating data literacy cultivates critical thinking skills and promotes digital citizenship.

[01:35:41] Strengthening content connections fosters deeper understanding. Explicitly embedding Virginia's math process goals enables students to see the inner relationships among all ideas. And increasing rigor and depth affords students opportunities to develop conceptual understanding while simultaneously preparing them to compete on a global scale.

[01:35:59] together these research informed five areas of focus will equip our students with the skills necessary for success and provide them with a competitive advantage that enhances their employability prospects in conclusion i urge the system board to prioritize the intentional enactment of a research informed mathematics education grounded in excellence and approve the proposed 2023 mathematics standards of learning and ultimately the five areas of focus thank you for your time and consideration of these requests thank you uh karen riddick followed by emily branch

[01:36:32] morning good morning mr president other board members dr coons i'm karen riddick i serve as the um chief human resource officer for greensville county public schools under the leadership of dr kelvin edwards thank you all so much for your efforts in understanding the needs of school divisions across the commonwealth in regard to teacher shortages and allowing us to be here to speak on behalf in support of iTeach as an alternative teacher education program.

[01:37:10] In Greensville County, it's a rural area, we employ about 187 teachers. We have 43 who are currently on provisional licenses, 30 international teachers. Out of the 43 provisional licenses, 29 of those expire June 30th, 2023, and they have not completed their education requirements.

[01:37:32] a lot of those barriers have been for um they can't afford the cost and this is in addition to the tuition reimbursement that we give them for these courses so it is really um we were excited about the idea of i teach because it is affordable and because it is time effective what we have done as a division in this teacher shortage you know we have become the teacher education program for our teachers we have created a new teacher support program we have hired a new teacher support coordinator we have employed three part-time mentors for the division and then each new teacher

[01:38:07] is giving a seasoned mentor within their building we have support sessions monthly we have professional development for these teachers to support them because we've learned that they will stay with us if we support them we had 21 that we employed this year we lost three and i think our new teacher support program really helped us in keeping those teachers so if i teach we need some help to be able to get these teachers licensed quicker um so that we can keep these teachers in our small division in all divisions i think we will all impact um teaching greatly as we know the numbers

[01:38:42] are decreasing where people are no longer going to school singing i want to be a teacher and so we have to find the best fit for our divisions and those who are eligible for a provisional license iTeach will

help us get our teachers licensed quicker and keep them in the profession. Thank you so much for your consideration and for voting to choose iTeach for an alternative

[01:39:03] education program. Thank you. Thank you. Emily Branch followed by Amy Beaumont. Good morning, Board President, Board Members, and Superintendent Coons. My name is Emily Branch and I'm the Chief Human Resources Officer of Dinwiddie County Public Schools. We are in a rural area and I, along with with my colleagues who have spoken before me are oftentimes competing and considering

[01:39:41] the same pool of candidates during this night. Pleasure to speak with you this morning in regards to my support of the board approving the iTeach program as an alternative route to licensure. I'd like to call attention to priority two of your published priorities, which says that you will advance priorities that increase the number of candidates entering the teaching profession and encourage and support the recruitment, development and retention of well-prepared and skilled teachers and school leaders.

[01:40:13] Among many other school divisions that have come today seeking your approval, I would like to base my reasoning on three factors: credibility, flexibility and affordability, and supportability and retainability. Credibility. We already have heard that I teach as a CAPE accredited program.

[01:40:32] I teach is also already approved in several states, and I would love for Virginia the commonwealth of virginia i mean to be one of them as far as flexibility and affordability affordability i teach offers over 30 endorsement areas for certification we can very well much benefit from those endorsement areas especially from elementary education and special education as it would help us in having a predetermined list of approved content areas that would be beneficial to us who lack the resources of providing on-the-spot licensure evaluations for prospective applicants.

[01:41:11] iTeach also provides our teachers the opportunity to be able to complete this training in the comforts of their home at a fraction of the traditional cost and would also remove some of the financial burdens that many of our up-and-coming teachers experience at this time.

[01:41:30] concerning supportability and retainability dcps denwoodie county public schools has a new teacher induction process that would support teachers while they complete the i-teach program our induction program consists of onboarding orientation and assign mentors and liaisons for the first year to ensure our teachers have a smooth transition our onboarding includes introducing them to our organizational culture to online tools and to resources that are available in the school system as they come into their first year as a teacher orientation includes an

[01:42:09] intensive all-day pd training that is based on professional development from james strong and his book called smart from the start lastly our new teachers support ment and mentors support them on a monthly basis to cover various topics that would also complement the iTeach program.

[01:42:30] In conclusion, I believe that this streamlined program will be successful in increasing our recruiting and retention efforts and will help us in our efforts of reducing our 50-plus provisionally licensed teachers and ongoing in our school division. Thank you so much for your time.

[01:42:48] thank you amy followed by dr deb crawford good morning good morning math sol revision is an opportunity to implement science-based standards cognitive science scientists have long stressed the importance of memorizing math facts to provide the building blocks for problem solving just as phonics provide the building blocks for literacy despite this virginia's 2016 sols don't

[01:43:25] ask students to know any math facts from memory. The proposed draft rectifies this. Kudos. That is a significant step forward and will help Virginia students solidify their math foundations. The department should go even further by highlighting standard algorithms as well. While the incorporation of the science of math is excellent, there are other areas of the draft where this could be made.

[01:43:47] First, the draft emphasized conceptual understanding and applications, advocating for going deeper into a reduced number of big ideas however like squeezing a balloon if you go deeper in one area you may spend you're going to spend less time in another unfortunately the draft delays and deletes important math content throughout the grades two-digit multiplication addition of fractions were delayed a year sizable chunks of math analysis were deleted these delays and deletions reduce rigor not enhancing even the pro core fordham institute

[01:44:24] sorry the pro common core fordham institute warned virginia that it overemphasized applications in its 2016 sols despite this the current draft skews even further towards applications second given longing given learning losses the proposed standards should focus on for math instead the draft adopts the Virginia Math Pathways Initiative's call for inquiry learning data analysis.

[01:44:50] The administration ended VMPI, so why is it appearing in the draft SOLs? Inquiry-based data cycles are time-consuming and technology-intensive. The draft has students pose questions, conduct surveys and experiments, and calls for third graders to graph data and spreadsheets. Not many eight-year-olds know how to make Excel charts. Are you going to teach them the Excel and math class and take math time for that surveys experiments technology instructions have no mathematical content so why place them in math class throughout virginia educators are searching for innovative

[01:45:28] ways to boost instructional time for math to remediate learning loss well here's an idea take out the data cycles from the sols which will allow teachers to devote a hundred percent of time to math and math class to math the sols can still cover probability and statistics the same as they always have. The issue is the inquiry learning component. That issue should be left to the

[01:45:51] districts. Thank you. Thank you. Dr. Deb Crawford followed by Janelle Spitz. Honorable Chairman, Virginia Board of Education and Superintendent Kuhns, thank you for the opportunity to speak today. My name is Dr. Deb Crawford and I serve as Mathematics and Moral Language Supervisor in Frederick County Public Schools and a lead on the Virginia Data Science Team. I support the 2023

[01:46:28] virginia math's standards of learning revisions because of what they offer our learners the five focal points of the revisions ensure that all virginia students receive an education grounded in excellence are proficient in k-12 math and are college and career ready all five focal points are important one design a coherent progression from one year to the next two build a data literacy skill sets so valued across all job sectors three emphasize big ideas and connections between concepts to support stronger understanding and achievement four teach through the math process

[01:47:06] goals five build deep mathematical understanding through tasks with high cognitive demand i'll choose one to highlight data literacy today's learners already live in a world defined by data about a percent of the world's data has been created in the past two years employers are desperate to find workers with data related skills data already plays a pivotal role in our homes our workplaces and our communities but not yet in most classrooms the 23 sol math revisions offer a solution a vertical k-12 progression of experiences using the data cycle to develop data

[01:47:45] literacy so valued by the workforce data literacy is quickly becoming a fundamental requirement for professionals in every discipline and industry as traditional conceptions of data have changed it will be vital that students know how to use the an iterative process to formulate questions collect or acquire data clean analyze and model with data in order to communicate results for decision making early exposure matters the national academies of sciences engineering and medicine noted that early exposure leads to expanded access later in data science fields have you heard about

[01:48:23] the data science and literacy act of 23 even the u.s house of representatives has created that literacy act in order to provide grants to schools to increase funding for data literacy and data science data science is not a subject just for some it is a skill set for all and all of our students will be come it will be coming for all of our students in the new revised math standards of learning please retain the original implementation timeline in order to plan to do this well and approve the revised math standards of learning thank you for all you do for our virginia learners

[01:49:02] thank you janelle spitz followed by kim hammond good morning president gecker superintendent koons and board members i'm janelle spitz recruitment and retention coordinator for newport news public schools and i thank you for this opportunity to speak for the approval of i teach this has been my 25th year with newport news public schools i started my education journey as a provisional english teacher moved to school administration as an assistant principal and principal and currently

[01:49:38] serve our division as recruitment and retention coordinator newport news public schools has provided me with amazing opportunities for learning and growth and i know many others who can say the same none of this would have been possible had it not been for a provisional teaching license and the support i received from newport news i was several years out of college with a bachelor's degree in psychology and a full-time non-teaching job quitting my job to return to school to become a teacher was not an option a provisional teaching license allowed me time to finish the classes i needed to become a teacher what it did not allow for was a flexible affordable

[01:50:14] way to take these classes after teaching students all day i would attend school several nights a a week until 10 p.m. I'm not sure how I managed to do this, but I can tell you without a doubt, I would not be able to do this today. And it's not just because I'm 25 years older. The teaching profession has changed, resulting in increasing stress and burnout among our teachers, and especially among those within their first five years. We've lost good teachers who were not able to finish their provisional requirements due to cost and time. The VDOE can continue to provide teaching candidates with flexible paths to licensure. Newport News can

[01:50:49] provide supports for our new teachers, such as New Teacher Welcome Week, a robust mentoring program, New Teacher Institute, and PLCs. And iTeach can provide affordable, flexible, quality courses that will allow teachers to enhance, not exhaust, their teaching capabilities. Traditional education programs have their place, but they are not graduating as many education majors as years past, and they are not a viable option for adults looking for a change of career. And particularly, the need for iTeach is urgent for those candidates who want to become elementary or special education teachers. In elementary school we are building the education foundation and our students with

[01:51:27] disabilities need teachers with the knowledge to create individualized educational plans to meet the needs of each learner. Every candidate we lose due to a lack of flexible affordable options is a detriment to our children and our current teachers who take on additional responsibilities because there

is not enough teaching staff. ITEACH offers us one solution to the teaching shortage by eliminating barriers and opening doors to future teachers. By approving their application as submitted, we will be one step closer to providing qualified teachers in

[01:52:00] every classroom for every student. Thank you. Thank you. Kim Hammond. Good morning, President Gecker, Superintendent Koons and board members. My name is Kim Hammond and I'm the training and development coordinator for newport news public schools and i'm here to advocate for the approval of i teach like you newport news is committed to ensuring every classroom has a knowledgeable engaged and supported teacher thank you for advancing policies that increase the number of

[01:52:37] candidates entering the teaching profession and encourage and support the recruitment development and retention of well-prepared and skilled teachers newport news public schools educates 28 680 children and 42 schools we employ 1700 teachers we have approximately 475 licensed teachers who are on provisional license at this time our five-year data trend suggests that we will hire approximately 250 teachers this year your decision today will directly impact them

[01:53:12] in the trajectory of their lives and their students as you know many of the teachers that we will hire will be on a provisional path we are also concerned about the rising number of provisionally licensed teachers who are their license are expiring they're leaving the profession and we need an additional option we have i have served as an english teacher lead teacher assistant principal and principal at the elementary middle and secondary levels in virginia for 31 years i remember being told as an english teachers we were a dime a dozen we know that that is no longer

[01:53:50] are true. The teacher shortage is definitely real. Today, an integral part of my job is connecting newly hired teachers with pathways to licensure. I teach is an option to ensure that our teachers have highly trained and skilled teachers in their classroom. The I teach program offers two characteristics that are crucial in today's labor market, affordability and flexibility.

[01:54:14] Newport News is a division that firmly believes that smart is something that you become. This This philosophy comes alive in our work with our students and our adults. We are dedicated to developing the expertise of our teachers and offering a variety of structures to support professional learning and growth.

[01:54:31] I teach participants will be supported by a mentor, team, lead teacher and building level coordinators. I teach candidates will participate in the Newport News Mentor Program. The program features a strong focus on coaching, collaboration, feedback and reflection and and advances new teachers growth and development.

[01:54:50] I teach participants grades K through five will be supported by our teacher coaches. I teach participants will also be supported by curriculum supervisors and specialists. This is a coaching, visiting classrooms, offering specialized PD, providing resources and collaboratively developing lessons.

[01:55:08] We also identify model teachers for each grade level and core content areas. My role to monitor the progress and success each iTeach participant i think the board for the opportunity to be heard please approve iTeach imagine july 1 new hires on an immediate path and better prepared for the first day of school thank you thank you all right that actually uh exhausts i guess the list of people who have signed up uh is there anybody else who has not had an opportunity to speak previously who would

[01:55:44] like to address the board sir morning morning sir sorry i didn't know the system had changed i'd emailed this web to sign up to speak my name is rich lieberman i'm from spotsylvania county first i want to thank both the outgoing board members and the ones still here public service is not easy so thank you for your time you get people like me coming up to yell at you i'm here to follow up on your statements about the licensure of mark taylor in spotsylvania county um when you were considering a license for him under option four which states the way someone

[01:56:22] without education experience can be granted a superintendent's license i came and spoke about another portion of the law 8 vac 20-390-10 it showed additional requirements of law above option four that mark taylor did not meet for example experience saying he had at least five years of education experience saying you had to have it within the past four years um when i spoke about it before you granted the license you guys ignored it you focused on a social media post the next month a bunch more spots when your residents came down myself another one person

[01:57:00] spoke about this law and mr gecker you said yes it does seem to be in conflict with what this board did and you were going to send it to the attorney general and get an opinion botsavania is waiting we haven't heard anything it's been what seven eight months so i'm not sure um so i did a foia and the information so this botsavania sent this code that i'm talking about to john russell who was i believe was a specialist superintendent for the then uh he was a special assistant to the then state superintendent um and you know it's it's in the

[01:57:37] news it's in it's in the news at this law but it also shows that john russell never forwarded it to anybody else. Then what's the hiring process was ev Russell was given a job i was created the day before a position that we'd nev after you granted Mr. I' I'm sorry. Since the time waiting for you to answer spiraled. Parents are now by senior staff, includin in person and online. When filed within the school s

[01:58:16] The school system policy says they're supposed to respond in 15 days. It's been three months, but we file our complaints, and within hours they're posted on an attack website on a Saturday, but yet we still can't even get a response from our school system. We have staff leaving in droves.

[01:58:32] We have teachers being fired for speaking out. Others are leaving because they're afraid of what senior staff will do next. This is an area where, as you're hearing, it's tough to get educators. Spotsylvania is hurting even more than all these other jurisdictions. We just had an amazing educator announce Monday night she was leaving the county years because of the beha Um, I don't know if you r had the state future of t this part, guess what? Sh County. Um, when will you up and fix this? Give us

[01:59:09] you. Thank you. Anybody e can get one. Thank you. Hi is Don Shelley. I live in I begin my main comments. I want to mention to you how horrible it is for you to require teachers to sign their lives away just to administer SOLs. If you would like to know more, please call me.

[01:59:48] My number's there. Now on to my main topic. You approving a non-educator with a superintendent's license. In September, you mistakenly allowed a non-educator to receive a superintendent's license. When you thought you could license someone under Option 4, you forgot about Administrative Code 8VAC20-390-10.

[02:00:12] You ignored the part of the Virginia Code that states the applicant shall have at least five years of a satisfactory and full-time experience in administration, supervision, or both in public schools. When you were told about this, you sent it for an opinion to the Attorney General.

[02:00:31] you should have done that before approving the license. When you submit your request, when did you submit your request for that opinion? We're still waiting. Now I want to tell you about the blunder, another blunder that you made, which contradicts someone being approved under option four while ignoring the section about instructional experience. On March 17, 2022, you approved the guidelines of uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for

[02:01:04] superintendents. In the guidelines that you approved, the word instructional was stated 49 times. The term instructional leadership was stated 14. A few statements from your guidelines include, while not directly influencing student achievement and instruction, the superintendent is an instructional leader who must focus on increasing effectiveness.

[02:01:33] It also states research findings indicate that superintendents of effective school divisions exhibit high levels of involvement in instructional matters, including instructional goal setting.

[02:01:49] One more for good measure. He or she is expected to be a strong instructional leader Converse it with information about educational best practice you approving the gentleman in Spotsylvania, in my opinion, was a huge gap on your part, please fix it and let us know what's going on with the Attorney General, thank you so much, and I hope you all have a lovely summer.

[02:02:24] Mayor Mrakas: Thank you so anybody else would like to address the board, who has not done so yet today I can't see around the corner, but.

[02:02:35] Mayor Mrakas: All right, then we're going to close public comment Thank you everybody for being with us for that we're going to take a 10 minute break and then we'll come back and do the normal work agenda we're going to call the meeting back.

[02:14:02] Mayor Mrakas: In order here first item is the consent agenda there's only one item it's the final review to certify a list of qualified persons for the office division superintendent schools. Is there a motion to approve that item? I'll move.

[02:14:19] Thank you, Ms. Halton. Thank you, Dr. Siebert. All in favor, say aye. Aye. Okay. Item B, first and final review of Amendment 6 to Virginia's Consolidated State Plan. Ms. Siebert. It's just there.

[02:14:45] It's okay. Yeah.

[02:15:03] Many times I wanted to run and hide also, so I don't blame you one bit. Good morning. Good morning. Pardon me? I say good morning. Good morning, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, Superintendent Coons, and board members.

[02:15:22] Today I'm presenting a first review of proposed amendment 6 to Virginia's Consolidated State Plan. The purpose of the Consolidated State Plan is to provide information about how the Elementary and Secondary Education Act, as amended by the Every Student Succeeds Act, will be implemented in Virginia.

[02:15:43] component of the consolidated state plan is our federal accountability system our federal accountability system is used to identify low performing schools that are in need of support there are eight indicators that are used to identify schools and two of them are growth indicators one in reading and one in mathematics the growth indicators include students who pass the state assessments and students who fail the state assessments but demonstrate growth in december of 2022 the u.s department of education approved amendment 5 to virginia's

[02:16:20] consolidated state plan amendment 5 includes the growth methodology that was in place during the 21-22 school year which was a comparison of spring 2021 state assessment results to spring 2022 state assessment results and fall 2021 growth assessment results to spring 2022 state assessment results if necessary this methodology is outdated due to the change in growth assessments in 2324 communication

[02:16:54] from the uscd also indicated that the use of two comparisons in the growth determination methodology could only be approved for 21-22 school year based on flexibility related to the pandemic therefore a revision to the methodology is required for the 22-23 school year and beyond the revision to the growth methodology and amendment six is a minor adjustment to the consolidated state plan for use in the 23-24 accountability year which is based on this school year's data there will be ample discussion between stakeholder groups the department and the board

[02:17:34] prior to further decision making regarding how growth will be measured and used in the reformed accountability system specifically the central component of amendment six is for a grade four through eight student to demonstrate growth for accountability purposes the student must have failed the previous year's sol or vap test and the current year's sol or vap test and then advanced at least one range on the progress table when comparing the scores on the previous and current year tests so basically for grades four through eight it is a year-to-year comparison and then for

[02:18:11] grade three students to demonstrate growth for accountability purposes the student must have failed the current year's sol test and then advanced at least one range on the progress table when comparing the current year fall growth assessment to the current spring sol test score the proposed growth methodology is the same methodology that was approved for the state's accreditation system at the april business meeting growth methodology in amendment six will provide consistency between the state and federal accountability models it will also satisfy the

[02:18:47] uscd's requirement to update the methodology so sorry okay we did provide the opportunity for stakeholder feedback there were few public comments but the comments received were in support of the amendment and in addition amendment six was reviewed by the committee of practitioners on may 17th to solicit stakeholder feedback the committee was unanimously supportive of the

[02:19:26] methodology and the general feedback was that it made sense to align the federal and accreditation growth methodologies so that it's not confusing to divisions and stakeholders the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education waive first review and approve the TAB, The proposed amendment six to Virginia's consolidated state plan for submission to us ED okay there any questions by board members don't see any so the presentation was incredibly complete, thank you.

[02:20:01] TAB, Is there a motion to wave first review and adopt this item. TAB, Thank you, Dr man is there a second. TAB, Second. TAB, yeah Thank you, Mr certifan all those in favor signify by saying aye. TAB, Any opposed. TAB, Thank you very much.

[02:20:16] TAB, Thank you very much. Okay, item C, final review of divisions partnering with ITCH to provide an alternative route to licensure. Mr. Chapman. Thank you, and good morning, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, members of the board, and Dr. Kuhns.

[02:20:33] Item C is the final review of the applications from divisions partnering with ITCH to provide an alternate route to licensure. I'll try to keep this presentation brief because I know you've already heard a lot about this. As you well know, back in 2019, legislation passed which added subsection N to 22.1.

[02:20:52] 298.1 of the code of virginia which required that the the board establish guidelines to process and a process to permit a school board or any outside organization sponsored by a school board to petition for approval of an alternate route to licensure the legislation allows for the alternate route to include alternatives to the regulatory requirements for teacher preparation including alternative professional assessments and coursework and of course specifies that either the petitioner may proffer or the board may impose conditions in conjunction with the approval of any

[02:21:27] any petition received by the board this item came for first review in april of 2023 and following that the board had additional requests for documentation from iteach which included a comparison of coursework requirements of virginia with other states data on teacher effect 22 study published by the university of texas and a coursework crosswalk which was provided to the board in advance of of this meeting in advance of the work session yesterday of course the work session yesterday you heard from i teach on a number of uh of those points um and have received public

[02:22:01] comment both in written format today i would like to draw a couple of uh attention to a couple of um alterations in the board agenda item which will be published um the one of the main ones is that we have received a couple of additional applications and so we have updated the boilerplate to hopefully for administrative expedience to make sure that as many divisions as have provided applications are in fact approved by the board today all these applications are substantially similar to the ones already provided in the material but the additional applications are from amherst county public schools from hopewell city public schools and from isle of white county

[02:22:40] public schools and i believe someone from isle of white might have made public comments today we also following the uh the work session yesterday do have a superintendent's recommendation that as you may have noticed was absent from the original boilerplate but the superintendent of public construction is would recommend that the board approve the applications from the school divisions subject to the following conditions the first is that you know arising from the workstation yesterday that i teach maintained its accreditation through the council for the accreditation of

[02:23:17] educator preparation otherwise known as cape that the petitioning divisions comply with the provisions of the virginia literacy act for teachers which of course was also a condition that was imposed upon the arlington county application the montessori application that the board approved a few board meetings ago that the petitioning divisions prior to the beginning of the school year submit plans for approval by vdoe to support the alternate route with a mentorship program and that the partnering divisions and i teach submit data on quality and effectiveness to the videoe on an annual basis um be happy to you know answer any questions that

[02:23:56] i might be able to and certainly thank you for your your time commitment to this issue and this matter today sure any questions by board members thank you mr chatlin can you just repeat i'm sorry the the language of the superintendent's recommendation with respect to mentorship i can do that the petitioning divisions prior to the beginning of school year submit plans for approval for the alternate route in the mentorship program so we had several speakers today that talked about the mentorship program they have we just like to have that on file to make sure we're

[02:24:29] supporting our newest um educators to ask do you think that that language is sufficient that you would be able to make changes in the event the plans don't meet your limits we would be happy to support our school divisions and making sure they have strong mentorship programs i guess i'm asking in a different way if the divisions submit a mentorship program are we just checking the box and saying you've submitted the plan or is there a review that could lead to this route not being

[02:25:08] available if the mentorship programs weren't considered to be sufficient at the department we want to make sure and had a conversation this morning as we think about mentorship programs that we're not putting unfair expectations on our rural divisions who are struggling just to get staffing so i'm happy to say we'll we will support them we have to make sure that we hold some equitable opportunities for the diverse supports that our districts have our school divisions have that's incredibly fair and i appreciate that response as you know one of the boards adopted soq's prescribed soq items deals with establishing statewide better mentorship

[02:25:47] support around our newer teachers you know we have yet to get that through the general assembly i'm hopeful that that's one of the things you guys will do when i'm gone is get that one through but uh yeah certainly you know it would be i think you're right unreasonable to expect more of some of the under-resourced jurisdictions than they can possibly do to make this work thanks for that response Dr Siebert yeah I appreciate that and look forward to that support because I do think there needs to be a scalable response and in a very small rural division we'll have a smaller number and they can provide so I appreciate that I think that's important I do think some of the applications had more mentorship built in than others so I think that

[02:26:25] kind of check and balance there from superintendents office will be good thank you Mr Chapman really my look for's I took a little bit of issue with the you know please accept without conditions I I think it's the role of this board to create conditions for success and processes moving forward.

[02:26:41] So I'm glad to hear that the maintaining CAPE is there, that the mentorship piece is there. I still have an issue that for any of the sample agreements, there would be a sole source piece. I mean, I believe in high-quality options, and so I want to support high-quality options, and why one high-quality option would then restrain other options is still a little bit concerning for me, but hopefully local divisions will now be aware of that issue and they will be attentive to the agreement and they will seek to strike that particular provision.

[02:27:15] Mr. President, thank you for the update, Mr. Chapman, and for the superintendent's recommendations. Maybe just to be a little contrary, I do think that we have heard from so many superintendents and their staffs today from around the Commonwealth. It was refreshing to hear what they're doing from a mentorship and a professional development and training program across the board. And I just, that's where the accountability rests. It rests with

[02:27:51] the individuals, it rests with the districts. And I just have a challenge understanding why we would want to be folding anything in on top of that for mentorship. They're the ones that have reasons to succeed and I just think we need to be a little careful this shortage that we're facing to be putting restrictions conditions whatever you want to call them on this and while we're trying to bring every possible tool to us and obviously with integrity and accountability across the board

[02:28:27] and I think that I just want to make sure we're not limiting suffocating innovation entrepreneurship excellence. And I just, I do want to thank all of those who took the time today to come

up. And it was refreshing to see the amount of innovation going on, the amount of activity going on to address this major issue. And this major issue is going to get more major as we go forward with

[02:28:59] The enrollment cliff in higher education hitting us in a few years, and I just think as well with the headwinds that we've got on the backlog and the licensing to be able to get this kind of uncapped untapped to be moving forward aggressively that encumbered would be my recommendation.

[02:29:24] Any other comments? Yeah. Well, I'd just like to come in and I teach folks for doing a great job presenting the information about their program yesterday and in writing to us.

[02:29:40] And I commend the districts and I teach for looking for innovative alternatives to address our our our teacher shortage. I think I do have a couple of suggestions about conditions, additional conditions. I would suggest we consider before addressing them, I would just say that I think it's worth recognizing that provisional licensing has become a bigger and bigger part of our teacher workforce and is going to become bigger and bigger.

[02:30:12] And I think that in light of the low cost alternatives i teach is providing which is a great thing that this will become a bigger and bigger part of how our provisional licensees get licensed such that it will essentially overtake almost the whole would be my prediction and what we're talking about here i mean the applications that we've received with the additions today cover virtually the whole state you know the percentage wise it's all the big divisions um and it's it's it's just a sufficiently major change that we ought to be

[02:30:52] making sure we get it right which i know everybody on the board wants to do and because this provision does require board approval it is in the board's discretion to impose conditions to help make it work um and i do think that the recommendations from the superintendent all are in the spirit of recommendations that help make it work i would add one well i would suggest we consider adding one additional and i'd be interested to hear uh mr siebert's thoughts on it since he knows this better than me but that we uh simply provide a add a condition that so that the contracts

[02:31:28] not include any sole source provider terminology and then on as to the mentoring program my preference would be that we add language requiring as a condition of our approval which we have full discretion to do that the divisions have at least by year two of implementation in place mentoring programs that meet the prescriptions of the board in the soqs which we

[02:32:04] adopted in 2021 in which the new board the newly constituted board after july 1 will will have a chance to update but we did look at a lot of research in those 2021 prescriptions and determined that high quality mentor programs are crucial for onboarding new teachers and we put some very specific terminology in there to help implement that recognizing that it hasn't been fully funded yet by the legislature there's no reason local divisions can't choose to implement it and that would be my preference barring that i would suggest that

[02:32:37] we put in language uh requiring that the mentor programs be consistent with the board with the department's guidelines for high quality mentor programs that were adopted and made available across the commonwealth in i think uh october of 2021 um so the guidelines for mentoring programs if we just say have mentor programs they all have mentor programs they're all required already to have mentor programs but as we know there are some that work and some that don't uh and i think that how recognizing that our provisional licensees don't have the benefit of clinical experience

[02:33:13] typically uh that the mentor program is just the research suggests that the mentor program is crucial to their success barring that if if the board is not comfortable requiring a ref including a reference to the department's published guidelines on mentor programs which are i think very flexible and wouldn't you know rural programs urban programs large small programs can all find a way to fit within those guidelines barring that i would suggest we at least add language of high quality mentor programs recognizing that that's vague but it does give the department something to work with when they review these programs if we just require

[02:33:51] them to have mental programs they it's essentially meaningless so i would just add to i would ask that we add to the superintendent's language high quality mentor programs dr man yes i actually had a question related to miss holton's uh reference to the soqs and particularly because i mean i'm thinking about one of the speakers we heard this morning from the virginia counties i'm going to get the acronym wrong so i won't try they go they go there you go um i mean he did bring to our

[02:34:26] attention the importance of trying to balance understanding the cost of what we're expecting and so i'm curious if we align with the soqs which absolutely is is very sound thinking given all the work that we've done if it's not funded if the districts lack the funding to align with that are we going to include a provision that does not that that addresses that because i i think if if we are concerned about smaller jurisdictions that may not have the capacity i i can't call

[02:35:00] forward you know what those requirements were but i would i would encourage that we we consider that if we're going to add that as as a requirement just given what we know localities then have to figure out what to do how to do those things and so i'll just leave it curious about it so if i may respond the the the specifics of the soq is one uh full-time equivalent position or one full-time position or its equivalent for every 15 first second and third year teachers

[02:35:37] and also that um uh that there there's other provisions for more experienced teachers but that would be the part i would be referencing the beginning teachers and also that the mentee teachers be given at least an hour of release time a week to meet with their mentees i think those oh i think those are the substantive provisions um and that it lasts for three years all of which i think we supported with the research we cited in our and supported the soqs that we adopted the uh with respect to funding i think you're right that the the state share of the funding

[02:36:14] is not yet mandated by the general assembly hopefully it will be provided at some point but in the meantime many many divisions most divisions go well beyond soq funding as is the divisions will be divisions and their teachers anyway together will be reaping considerable savings through the use of iTeach which is a wonderful thing and that perhaps some of that savings between the teachers and the division can be somehow redirected many divisions if i understand correctly help pay for the teachers educational programs so this will be that's one

[02:36:54] of the reasons they're pushing forward it's such an economical option for it so alternatively if that is troublesome the the guidelines are uh put meat on the bones of what high quality mentorship program means but without uh that uh without in a much more flexible way yes no i agree i i think I think the work that was done to set those expectations and the SOQs are very important.

[02:37:22] And maybe it's more about making strides towards that. I mean, I do struggle with mandates that don't come with resources. And I think we have to really make certain, given all that we are contending with, that we try to balance that.

[02:37:39] So maybe it's making strides in that way if the funding doesn't come through to really supporting that effort. So on that, I would just say, then you might, we might want to consider instead that we have two, well, three alternatives I'm suggesting.

[02:37:56] One is the SOQ provisions, the other is the department's guidelines on mentoring programs, which were issued for the state in as guidelines in in October of 21, I believe. And I would just be suggesting that we, and those guidelines are much more flexible as to specifics, so would accommodate.

[02:38:19] different divisions doing mentoring in different way um uh that we've used that guideline instead of the soqs or alternatively that we simply just add the high quality mentor program language so as to give the department something to work with in their conversations with the districts mr president yes sir um i watched the i teach presentation and they put on a good presentation but more importantly to me i watched all the different divisions come forward and ask for this

[02:38:53] the divisions are ready to move forward. I'm strictly opposed to any additional conditions that will put the brakes on and slow these divisions down. I think we should trust the local school divisions on their local boards who were elected to do their job without us putting additional conditions on what they want to do. Virtually every school division that came up talked about their mental program. They're not all the same. They're unique to those divisions.

[02:39:27] they will work for those divisions by adding any other conditions um mr siebert you brought up the point of your concern about um the the way the wording of the contract was by bringing that concern out every school division now knows about it and they have an opportunity at their level to strike it or keep it i think we need to sit back um support this program without any additional

[02:39:59] conditions. Thank you. Ms. Kruse? I just wanted to make a couple of comments on the recommendations for the conditions. I'm fully in support of ensuring that they maintain CAID accreditation. That's something that we expect of all IHE's that have EPPs.

[02:40:23] In addition, we are also working with IHE's and their EPP programs on VLA compliance. And so I don't think that that is an unreasonable request um so um i guess the other piece that i'd like to hit on i am a thousand percent in support of any kind of mentorship program and preferably as high quality as we can possibly have um you know we have school divisions that have amazing mentorship

[02:40:59] programs we have school divisions that check a box um and for for what it's worth the teeth that are not there in that request for a mentorship program to be had that just has has provided for that variability in mentorship programs at the division level all of that being said um you know i think that we will see as we you know move forward in some changes that we're going to see to our

[02:41:31] licensure process we will be able to gather a lot of that data um just sheerly by way of that process so i i think personally um the the two the first two conditions i'm fully in support of um and i think that just by way of moving forward in the processes and procedures that that we either have in place or are moving towards we will see these other two conditions um fall in line and then as as to the sole source piece of a contract yes mr certifan you have

[02:42:08] illuminated yes that will be something that all school divisions will now be made aware of and quite frankly i mean that's just a due diligence issue if you want that as a part of your contract keep that as a part of your contract if you don't you have um you know the ability to make that change. Um, so those

are my comments on this. Mr. President. Yes, sir. Um, every school division is different. And so when I hear that there are certain school divisions that are going to do well,

[02:42:43] but then there are school divisions that will simply check the box. Um, who are those school divisions? Um, the school divisions that have come forward have stated what their intentions are. So if there is a school division that is just checking a box, then I think our superintendent will address that and have a working partnership with them to get them to where they need to be

[02:43:16] the submission of plans to maintain capers and the mentorship as was pointed out i fully support those but no additional conditions this is a great program coming from rural county they the teachers are hurting we need more teachers if this program is going to help the school divisions that's why i support it time will tell whether or not i teach it's going to be a success it is not a success i expect school divisions to get rid of it and move on to something else but i

[02:43:54] do look forward to giving them an opportunity to give it a shot um mr president uh so a quick question for uh colleague creasy you said of the four we've talked about your supporting two i'd like to hear clarification what the two are because again i'm inclined to support our superintendent's recommendation uh because as superintendent i appreciated that kind of support so tell me refresh me on on the two that you're supporting the the maintaining cape accreditation and the vla compliance mostly because we did just have a situation a couple of meetings ago where we

[02:44:29] made sure that vla compliance piece was in there and we are requiring that of our ihe's and their epp programs the other two conditions i do think we'll process we'll process through that as we make some changes moving forward as far as licensure goes and mentorship i think is something that's already there and expected of our school divisions um that's and what i was saying was not in reference to anyone who has a current application my comments about mentorship programs were largely

[02:45:05] applicable to what we have in place right now and how school divisions are to be implementing mentorship programs so that wasn't anything directed towards current applications i wanted to clarify that considering how you're speaking to you know to that so can i just get some clarification on what are the implications for the vla application for the districts sure um currently vla requires either a literacy course or a micro credential and we're in the process of finally utilizing the micro credential either one could be offered the the course could be offered

[02:45:40] by ihe or the micro credential could be offered in a flexible way if i might add superintendent of course that requirement is statutory if i may ask the superintendent so my issue with respect to sole source provider i'll i lay that one aside um defer to the school districts on it but with respect to the mentorship program if the motion is adopted with your recommendations uh including your recommendation as to mentorship programs does that give the department authority and

[02:46:18] responsibility to ensure the divisions using i teach have effective mentor programs whether i i teach mentors i think we want to ensure that they have mentor programs i don't think we are equipped and ready to effectively implement mentor programs at the level of the guidance at this point in time. I think the code section and that deals with mentorship programs actually you know suggests that there's going to be funds appropriated by the General Assembly which as we

[02:46:56] know there are not enough funds appropriated by the General Assembly for this purpose. I mean I honestly was persuaded by the superintendent's answer with regard to you know right now it

might be effective she didn't say this but I'll say this you know check the box that is you got to a plan which is the current state law but to require at this point more than we're generally requiring for teachers you know it doesn't seem quite right particularly if the board leaves in which i hope we do although i heard some controversy on this the idea of the submission

[02:47:32] of data on quality and effectiveness i mean in my ideal world you know we would test things before we go you know statewide you know we don't have that kind of ability but the ability to come back three years from now with data much like we did frankly with montessori you know we said you know we got concerns uh let's establish a pilot you know that program was small enough that it was okay to do this one is clearly going to be much larger who knows where it'll be in three years but if we are collecting appropriate data on effectiveness and quality um i'm comfortable

[02:48:08] that the department will you know use that data three years from now or whenever you know steam the beast you know significant enough uh to guide locals as to whether this is something they ought to be continuing or not and so you know i'm comfortable because as i said i view item three the uh submit plans for approval is to check the box at this point just to let us know what they're doing i'm comfortable with these four conditions as drafted i would not like to see any of them go away so uh for what it's worth i i i still think the divisions can uh support effective mentor

[02:48:45] programs or they should hold their feet to the fire but i'm uh i can count so i won't belabor that point with respect to the data uh are are we adopting essentially the same conditions we adopted with respect to the montessori requirement which did it include coming back to us in three years we i don't recall and jim you have better recollection i don't think we had a data monitoring requirement but that we though limited the uh approval to three years and the contemplation was we would come back there was not the concern with montessori about quality everybody was comfortable

[02:49:20] there the concern was are we really just licensing teachers then to leave the jurisdiction and so we wanted to have and we talked about getting teacher retention data uh which will come back you know at the end of that three-year period you know that board at that time could decide whether to re-up or not based upon whatever criteria they want and would we be doing the same with this application these applications what you in the future decide to do with the data is up to you in the future that's not my question would our decision today to be is this essentially a three

[02:49:54] year approval with data i believe that's what the board's guidelines state of course you know so it would come back and we'll have to come back before us in three years that's correct and we will and - And again, with the annual submission of data, I will say I had, as I teach folks know, a fair number of concerns.

[02:50:13] I really appreciate greatly the approach they took yesterday and the provision of data that came promptly and not obfuscated and not to suggest you would do that, but I've certainly been involved with folks who have. And I think this is worth a try.

[02:50:29] I mean, you guys know how concerned I am about the longterm, But as Mr. Hanson correctly points out, we also have significant short-term needs. And certainly this is better than unprepared folks sitting in our classrooms.

[02:50:45] And I don't mean that quite the way it could be taken. I mean, very seriously, this is a better approach to what we're doing. And if we are willing to look at quality issues, and I heard Andy's comment

yesterday about, Kate not indicating anything, but I'm putting those to the side for the minute, Andy.

[02:51:04] if we're willing to keep the quality assurances in place for a three-year trial, basically, I think this is a good thing for us to do. Like I said, I disagree with those who want to eliminate the conditions entirely. I think it's perfectly appropriate, as we experiment in the Commonwealth with new things, to have limitations on it.

[02:51:21] I don't think it's necessarily appropriate to increase the cost or the burden to the locals to the point where it's unworkable to try. - Mr. President, I agree. And I don't know if when's an appropriate time for the motion. We'll come in in almost a second here, I think, unless Miss Holton wants to continue the discussion. It is now time, Bill.

[02:51:39] May I make one comment, Mr. President? Yeah, so I will support the superintendent's recommendation. I do think this board has the authority and responsibility to put conditions in. They shouldn't be burdensome, but these are fine. The CAPE one just seems like a matter of consistency at this point.

[02:51:55] I do think the data one, and I want to call out what Dr. Coons has been talking about and her leadership on really starting to modernize our data system. And so that we'll be able to answer these effectiveness questions in a much more sophisticated way, as some other states can now is going to be just enormously important to me.

[02:52:13] Like the VLA is is both statutory and obviously we we need to maintain that we're making strides. But the data piece of all this is actually that's the most important piece and is more important in my view than than the Cape accreditation over time. the other comment look i um i don't know that this board wants to get into the business of deciding which vendor provisions we strike in or out um i would respectfully suggest if you go through and you read a lot of vendor contracts you're going to see a lot of language that's problematic because the vendors have really good lawyers and there's a lot of stuff uh there's a lot of stuff in there and um i'll take my word for it there's a guy named rob waldrum ceo of um credium associates

[02:52:52] they do the i ready he did a video a couple years ago just like here's everything that is in these contracts that is not a great idea so like he's a he's a vendor and he was trying to do this as a as a public service so i don't want to i don't think we should start picking and choosing that's a rabbit hole but in addition to sort of my colleagues um mr ron's comment that now they're on notice people should be on sort of on notice in general that like there's a lot of stuff that that you want to think about in terms of preserving your your your um uh your agility but i just don't see a smart place to get into police contracts are a question with the locals

[02:53:28] right exactly so i just don't think it's our business to get into various various provisions but how good our lawyers are we're not going to comment on all every but the point is yeah exactly it is not our job to engage in contracts that's my that is my that is my view that there are a lot these i don't know that we want to start picking and choosing which ones merit our approval or not i will say i would trust you know just love to negotiate for me anytime thank you mr hanson i would move the adoption of the superintendent's recommendations on item three second uh any other

[02:54:05] comments all those in favor signify signify by saying aye aye aye any opposed great thank you very much mr chap now we tend we turn to the jenna conway hour thank you all for being here folks we

appreciate it good morning morning morning can i just take one moment of personal privilege is that possible of course i just want to thank these two ladies

[02:54:44] right here on all the work they do as a huge literacy advocate in my personal life i just want to thank these two ladies personally for all the work they are doing and continue to push on so thank you very much excellent thank you superintendent um i am pleased to bring to the board and for final review a key resource for implementing the virginia literacy act today we proudly present the core instructional program guide or the list of k-3 core curriculum that we have determined through a rigorous and comprehensive process performed by virginia educators to be aligned

[02:55:20] with evidence-based literacy instruction and science-based reading research as required by the virginia literacy act i'm joined here today with dr emma salari a nationally renowned literacy expert who's helped us set up and run this very important process you all are very familiar with the vla which we believe is a game changer for virginia and really all of the accomplishing all of the policy levers that help us ensure that we have a future where every student in virginia is a proficient reader by third grade and continues to stay on level or get on level by the end of eighth grade through the vla we are addressing the concerning literacy trends

[02:55:57] some of the setbacks that we experienced during the pandemic and we are focused on supporting every aspect of the system the resource in front of you today focuses on core curriculum the core english and language arts instruction focused on early literacy for kindergarten first and second and third grade um as a reminder this has been a very lengthy process and we have brought you updates along the way both in march and may it has been rigorous it has been transparent and it has been lined with the science and it has incorporated most importantly the inputs and efforts of hundreds of virginia educators from those who weighed in on the rubric those who

[02:56:36] served as reviewers and those who've offered public comment since we met in may we have posted all of the eight approved resources online and accepted public comment for more than 30 days as required by the textbook adoption process we have not received much public comment we have received some expressions of support for resources we've received questions about family resources and are working with the vendors on that and then we received a letter from a vendor that we've addressed with that vendor that's where we are today we hope that this board will approve for for final review and then there's a couple of next steps i'd like to highlight before turning

[02:57:12] it back to you first we we plan on sending out a superintendent's memo to make sure that all 131 school divisions are clear on next steps including the action steps that are needed by all those school divisions those include either choosing a core resource from this this list of eight if they are not interested in that if they're not already using an approved resource they will have the opportunity to wait for the cycle two results which we'll i'll talk about in a second but come at the uh end of this calendar year beginning of next or they need to submit their locally created resources by july 1st and so we want to make sure that all of our partners in our local school

[02:57:50] divisions are aware of these action steps and we get that information out to them second we have launched and are deep into cycle two um we have received more than 130 either additional core curriculum intervention or supplemental resources and we are working very closely with virginia literacy partnerships at the university of virginia to run a rigorous thorough and comprehensive process for all of those it means we will need more virginia reviewers and we will do a call for those but really making sure

that we are thoroughly vetting every resource so that school divisions have maximum choice and you can rest assured that we use high quality instruction materials across

[02:58:29] all of our k-5 classrooms as well as intervention and supplemental materials through grade eight and third we are hard at work on adoption resources and really thinking about toolkit training technical assistance the support that school divisions will need to actually fully implement curriculum it's not enough to have a list it's not enough to have purchased the box or kit or resources what we are really looking for is to support full implementation across all of our classrooms and we know that will take us working closely shoulder to shoulder with all of our school divisions over the next several years so with

[02:59:04] that um i would like to recommend on behalf of our superintendent of public instruction that this board provide final approving approval rather for the core instructional program okay any questions just briefly miss comley i do notice in the public comment we did hear from one school division or one school in addition to the vendors and i'm sure you're following up with them absolutely yes is there a motion to approve the virginia literacy act core instructional program

[02:59:38] that is presented in the item so moved thank you mr certifan thank you dr man all in favor okay miss conway you've got 54 minutes left all right my next item is related to improving school readiness so as a reminder the general assembly passed a law in 2020 directing this board to establish a unified quality rating and improvement system for all publicly funded birth to five providers in order to improve school readiness outcomes the wall laid out a clear timeline launch in 2021 provide two years for

[03:00:16] practice and would get optional participation and ultimately require by the start of this school year all publicly funded programs to participate so that we can release the results in the fall of 2024. so the recommendations in front of you for final approval today are the first the real recommendations that we will use with roughly 3 000 publicly funded sites and 12 000 classrooms this year earlier this year we walked through the proposed guideline changes i think we did a thorough job even though i was told to be speedy then too president gecker so i'm not going to go into too much detail there you made to say you're gonna listen this time i got it done i was very clearly

[03:00:55] the hour and i kept it to an hour but i am going to remind everybody listening to continue to emphasize the how we implement this law we are earnestly trying to do this in partnership with practitioners across the state from our head start partners to our family stay home partners to our schools our private child care programs our faith-based preschools church leaders principals teachers advocates really working closely with them to design implement and ultimately drive and continual improvement across our our sites in fact i spent six hours yesterday in a conference room engaging the public and private partners across the state on how we can make this year

[03:01:34] successful we know there'll be bumps along the way but we are committed to being responsive to our stakeholders largely for the reason that dr man has shared in the past that it is a choice to take public funds and our ability to serve the maximum amount of kids to meet parental preferences hinges on us being sure that we are truly and fully inclusive of the public and private sector lastly although i'm eating up my time here i do want to take a moment of personal privilege to thank the outgoing members of the board including president gecker vice president man and board member data swap special thanks goes to dr man who has served as the representative of the early

[03:02:09] childhood sector during a time of momentous change for our sector with a clear voice and committed heart she has led beautifully through the transition and the pandemic at the same time she has

served as a mentor to me and to our increasingly growing early childhood team and has helped us at every stage in the process better understand the perspectives of practitioners on the ground the educators who have dedicated their lives to ensuring that all children in virginia have the opportunity to enter kindergarten ready including my last one who's entering kindergarten after 10 years of having children in the publicly funded early childhood programs in louisiana and

[03:02:45] virginia paul is entering kindergarten this fall and i cannot thank you dr mann enough the only thing that makes me feel better and the reason i don't have tears in my eyes is that i know we will continue to hear from you as you implement bqb5 and your incredible program and know that you will continue to help us strengthen our incredible public-private birth to five system so with that on behalf of the superintendent of public instruction i recommend that this board provides final approval for the guidelines for 23-24 of the early childhood unified measurement and improvement system known as bqb5 is there a motion thank you dr mann i i wish i

[03:03:24] could let you second it too is there a second thank you mr hanson all those in favor say aye And, Jenna, let me just say, I was there the day that your hiring was announced. Five years ago this month.

[03:03:40] Five years ago, I watched you and your kids, you know, and what amazes me most, you know, usually we talk about life at the speed of government as being very slow, but the incredible changes that have been affected on your watch, you know, will just do wonders for the common will for many, many, many years.

[03:04:01] I mean, you have been instrumental in so much of the transformative change we're seeing in the, you know, I know pre-K, but also the K3 system. So thank you so much for what you've done. Thank you. Well said. All right, listen, this is the Jenna Lawrence 15 minutes, Jenna Cowley 15 minutes. Yeah, there you go. All right, I'm going to ask Mr. Williamster.

[03:04:29] yeah i spoke uh all in favor i thought we did let's do it again all those in favor say aye aye any opposed no okay all right my next item item f is related to health and safety in child care and so we've spent a lot of time talking about access and quality but this is the important third leg of the stool the health and safety licensing for child care including family child care child care centers faith-based preschools and other similar facilities in accordance with state law important reminder this is different from teacher licensure

[03:05:07] this is the the licensure of the sites the physical sites um and it includes things like teacher-child ratios hygiene and cleaning expectations safe sleep practices for infants and toddlers even regulations on diapering so you know we have about 6 000 sites statewide that range in size and scope from small voluntarily registered family child care homes that serve fewer than four kids to large programs that serve hundreds of kids and camps and after school we have under the leadership of our director jeff williams more than 120 staff who work in regional offices across the state and physically go into each of these sites and use these regulations as the template

[03:05:47] for inspecting the sites kind of going top to bottom through the regs using a tablet to capture the information electronically and checking for these health and safety regulations when we move licensing from the department of social services to the department of education in 2021 we kept the regulations as is and agreed to review them from top to bottom and so what we are bringing today to you as a nora for first and final review so we can kick off this process represents a really important step here

but this is also important to note how we did this and you'll notice a theme here of working very closely with the field for the last year and a half we have deeply engaged

[03:06:25] multiple private child care providers small business non-profit faith-based head start in a task force along with pediatricians and advocates that met for more than 25 hours over a 16-month period this group and a huge thank you to any of you who are listening today contributed their time their effort they read we wordsmith we came back we debated all in the mind of how do we keep this right balance between keeping infants toddlers and preschoolers safe but also not wanting to have so much burden that it becomes harder to operate right where it becomes more costly to operate thus forcing providers to go out of business and what we know from the data is the most dangerous

[03:07:04] situation for kids is unlicensed unregulated care we've added a few new standards to better protect children based on state or federal requirements or best-in-class practices and then in areas that were less critical to health and safety we've tried to reduce regulations and add new flexibility we've also been cognizant of the governor's executive order 19 and making sure that we're reducing regulation where possible while preserving the health safety and welfare of all of our children in care and our licensed wild day centers i'll now walk you briefly through the details um please don't hesitate to stop me at any point in time so this is just the nora today

[03:07:41] however uniquely we have also put forth a draft set of regulations so there is more clarity for the field on what exactly this means we know this often comes up licensing has a large effect on all of our sites big and small and so the intent here was to at the same time that we put out the nora put out a solid draft still a draft we will still welcome feedback over the course of the next year on these regulations but so the field understands exactly what we are talking about this repeal and replace will allow us greater flexibility it removes some duplicative requirements that were found in the code of Virginia reflects some best-in-class practices and then as I noted

[03:08:20] before seeks to align with executive order 19. A few highlights to note we've tried to and I know we talked in the previous item c about the workforce challenges in many ways those the workforce challenges and the teacher shortages that the child care sector is facing are even greater than that of the k-12 sector we just are hearing everywhere we go that they are understaffed and as a result fewer children are being served and working families in the commonwealth i find it very hard to work go to school or pursue greater self-sufficiently so we've tried to add additional flexibility more qualifications that enable you to be a lead teacher and then

[03:08:57] also making sure that your training you can kind of count it towards the annual requirements when you come on board we've tried to remove duplication of effort and unnecessary testing as the parents of a child children in school now i very much appreciate that i don't have to submit the same for multiple times for all of the camps and schools and after school um that was required previously and we have sought to increase ratios for school-age children which allows programs to bring in greater revenue aligns with some of the expectations for k-12 and does not put children in harm's way we are still working on a final count the office of regulatory management put

[03:09:33] out new guidance just this spring on how you count standards so that is still well underway we work very closely with the governor's office on that but overall this is a tighter more succinct and clearer set of regulations than the prior version that we believe had not been fully updated since 2005. this gives you a little bit more detail about the process and again just wanted to take a moment to just recognize the

names on the screen you'll see the the diverse set of providers from a family child care provider to owners of our centers to a preschool teacher

[03:10:10] from richmond public schools to folks from virginia tech from across the state to after school programs all were represented all were either around the table we some of this in person some of this via zoom but we went line by line it is their contributions their recommendations that we're bringing to you today i think that's a very important in terms of recognizing that this could not just be created in a room in richmond but truly needed to reflect the input of practitioners who do this every day one of the things that they said was important was making sure that the regulations were easier to use so it was not only just fewer words but clarity about you know sort

[03:10:47] of saying what we mean and meaning what we say and making sure that that was throughout the program doing some reorganization based on how our providers and private practitioners were actually So using the document and making sure that it was easier to use. We reduced unnecessary or redundant standards, and so those things where we had repeated over the years, we added a little bit here, added a little bit there, and trying to streamline and make sure they were in one section that was, from a common sense perspective, aptly named and that you could find out the information you need.

[03:11:18] We did and want to be transparent about this need to add some new standards and regulations. We had not fully updated this since 2005, and it was really important to take that step back and both look at our own data where kids have been in harm's way, as well as what were national best in class practices around a few or two kind of key examples to give you a sense of what I mean here.

[03:11:41] So one, for instance, we had not updated the language on sleep. And so our old regulations said that you could leave an infant fell asleep in a device. You could leave the infant there. have heard there's been very clear recommendations from the american academy of pediatrics and others is that is still dangerous so we've heard about the pack and play or the the swing and basically it's really not safe once that child is asleep because they could their neck could come down and they could self-suffocate and we know this is very dangerous in fact we've had five fatalities in the last year related to sleep and unlicensed unregulated homes and so it was really important

[03:12:18] that we basically changed that language to say you can't just leave the baby in the device anymore you need to move the baby to a flat safe surface that's kind of an example another example is we had a fatality in late 2021 of a school-aged child who was swimming who did not know how to swim and it inched along the pool into the deep end and then drowned even though there was a lifeguard present we added more language and additional requirement around staffing supervision so that you not only have a lifeguard but you have individuals who are responsible for keeping eyes you've probably heard this as we come into the summer season the importance of watching children right not just having a lifeguard on duty but making sure that there's a watcher or monitor for each child so we

[03:12:57] added that type of regulation to make sure that we can prevent fatalities like this from happening in the future and then lastly we added a few requirements that were required by state or federal code some things have been added to state law about lead testing for buildings built before 1978 so those were the the kind of the key requirements that were added we will this summer as we move forward do a cost analysis you've heard me talk a lot about looking at sort of speaking with one voice on health safety and learning expectations quantifying the cost for private providers and making sure that we're very thoughtful and transparent about that so we'll use

[03:13:35] the same group that helped us analyze the cost of quality to look at some of these changes and what the cost impact might be we think that there's opportunities for providers to bring in additional revenue in school age which often helps also subsidize the infant toddler and preschool classrooms um and so we think we hope that it'll be at at at minimum net balance zero in terms of cost impact um well we'll look very carefully at each of the each of the new requirements we also received a full endorsement after a very long meeting in this room and a fire drill which which involves taking the entire early childhood advisory committee down 22 flights of stairs and out into the parking

[03:14:14] lot and then back up during the course of a six hour meeting. And somehow, our incredible, extraordinary early childhood advisory committee still fully endorsed. You all think you're joking. And then everybody learned that about 36 hours after you've walked down 22 flights of stairs that your calf muscles for immensely.

[03:14:33] Yes, it is very true. So they will be billing us for Advil. but in addition to transportation. But in all seriousness, we went through every line of this. We had productive conversation. We had folks seeing things differently, but came to agreement. And we made a set of changes that are reflected here so that we received a full endorsement and have made all of the changes proposed, truly to reflect not only the work of the task force, but our fully representative early childhood advisory council, which supports this board.

[03:15:04] And then there's a set of next steps here. So again, we're looking for first and final review of the Nora. This is not approval of the regulations themselves, but we are putting out the regulations so that we are ultra transparent with the field.

[03:15:19] We will then work very closely with Mr. Chapman and the governor's office to get all of the right things in town hall, put things forward from public comment, complete that high-level cost analysis. And then we will bring back to this body for first review the actual regulations themselves.

[03:15:38] So with that, on behalf of the superintendent, we recommend that the board provide approval for first and final review of the NORA or Notice of Intended Regulatory Action for the Standards for Child Care Services. - Okay, any questions?

[03:15:54] I think so. Yep. Is there any motion then to waive first review and approve the NORA? - So moved. This is great work. - Yep, it is great work. There you go. Second. - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Mann. All in favor, say aye. - Aye. opposed thank you very much thank you president becker and i want to note the time so that i will bank that time for future presidents you know i will say jenna that was the record for the

[03:16:24] longest nora presentation i'm not sure you get additional time touche touche okay item g first and final review of proposed changes to certain testing requirements for writing do you shelly there's no they're coming hiding in the back again we're just going to give shelly a little bit of time since she is just returning in person from leave

[03:17:10] You know, thought we'd get through these two items, but I don't know how long the math standards, how long Dr. Alvin's planning to present. We had a fairly extensive presentation yesterday. Yeah, so it's nice to see you back.

[03:17:27] Thank you. Thank you very much. Good morning, President Gagher, members of the board, and Dr. Koons. Today, Sarah and I do bring to you for first and final review some proposed changes to certain testing requirements for writing.

[03:17:42] we begin i believe dr coons has some comments she wanted to add um really want to appreciate the board for looking at this item in first and final review as we've talked about making sure school divisions have the summer to plan for the following year um assistant superintendent loving writer and i spoke about the importance of making sure that we had this on first and final review today to make sure school divisions have good plans for assessment next year good plans if they sort of choose to make a balanced writing program and really have as as quickly as

[03:18:16] possible information to make good decisions for the 23-24 school year. Thank you Dr. Kunz. The actions we're asking you to take today are related to the development of a new item type that the student assessment staff has developed in the last couple of years and this item type is intended to be part of the uh grade five grade eight and of course uh reading assessments and the new item type is really intended to provide students with an opportunity to integrate reading

[03:18:49] and writing so students are provided with a passage passage is either based on reading or science content they are provided with about six multiple choice questions about the passage and then they are provided with a prompt that asks them to write about that passage.

[03:19:12] Really, the intent here is to support the idea of integrated reading and writing instruction and to also provide a measure of writing without an additional test. And for those of you who have been on the board for a while, we did provide you with a presentation about this new item type at the march 22nd board meeting and i think that was attached to this item so that you can look at that information in contrast to the idea of an integrated reading and writing item where we're asking students to write about what they've read i did also want to provide some context about

[03:19:51] our current tests so currently as you all know we have separate reading tests at grades three through eight and then also high school and of course in addition we still have two separate writing tests one given at grade eight and the other given at high school and of course these writing tests have been in place since 1998 and they do consist of two components the first component provides a a draft that would look like student writing and it asks the student to answer multiple choice or

[03:20:25] technology enhanced questions to revise that particular writing draft the second part of the test students are given a prompt which is usually in the form of a scenario or a situation or a question and asked to write a short paper in response to that prompt so those are the tests that are currently given for writing. From 1998 to 2014, we also had a grade five writing test, and with legislation that was passed in 2014, the General Assembly did eliminate

[03:21:03] five standards of learning tests, one of which was the grade five writing test. Since that time, based on that legislation, school divisions have been required to administer local alternative assessments in the areas in which those sol tests were administered so school divisions have been providing some sort of local alternative assessment for grade 5 writing and they have been required to create balanced assessment plans that describe how they will

[03:21:33] achieve that goal we have each year reviewed some of those balanced assessment plans a sample of school divisions but there has been no statewide measure of writing at grade five since 2014.

[03:21:52] The last time we talked with you all about this issue you did ask us to provide information about the pass rates for grade eight writing since the elimination of the grade five writing test and we did provide that for you in the boilerplate. So this particular item type was developed over the last couple of

years it was field tested this year that means it was tried out with students and so the plan is to implement it in the spring of 2024. in preparation for the implementation of the

[03:22:25] new item type we are asking you to take several actions today the first is we're asking you to eliminate the grade 8 writing test and there are a couple of reasons for this one we we know anecdotally that with the grade 8 writing test constructed as it is we do have school divisions who are teaching reading and writing separately the thought is they're separate tests so we instruct it separately so there might be half of a class period um focused on writing instruction the other half on reading and what we really want to support is that idea of integrated reading and

[03:23:05] writing instruction because that does really support literacy we want students to be writing about what they have read so that that's certainly one reason for uh supporting this change as dr kuhn said we are asking you to to weigh first review and one of the reasons for this is we do believe that school divisions will likely make some changes to their instructional practices in the coming year based on the elimination of the grade eight writing test and perhaps we'll focus as our instructional staff has been encouraging them to do on having students

[03:23:43] write about what they have read we never want assessment to drive instruction but we do want it to support good instruction wherever possible and we believe that eliminating the grade eight writing test will help to support the focus on that integrated reading and writing Additionally, as I mentioned, there have been local alternative assessment guidelines that have governed how school divisions deal with the areas in which SOL tests have been eliminated.

[03:24:14] We are asking you to also adopt new guidelines today. It's the guidelines for local alternative assessments for 2023-24 and beyond. And Sarah Susberry, Dr. Sarah Susberry, who's the director of student assessment is going to review those guidelines with you they are in an attachment in your board item yes as shelly mentioned these are in um attachment a and they were last adopted in 2021 for the 2021-22 school year and again they provide guidance to school divisions about the

[03:24:50] local alternative assessments that they must administer reflecting the assessments the sol tests that were eliminated by the 2014 general assembly they also require that the school divisions maintain a balanced assessment plan and this revised set of guidelines would reflect the opportunity for school divisions not to have to administer that grade five local alternative assessment in writing as a result of the addition of the integrated reading and writing item type

[03:25:24] at grade five so the the um information in the guidelines reflect that removal of a requirement to have the grade five writing local alternative assessment so just to clarify school divisions would still have the option if they chose to use a balanced assessment plan and a local alternative assessment but the new guidelines recommend that school divisions instead use the integrated reading

[03:26:00] and writing component of grade five um to meet that assessment requirement the superintendent of public instructions recommendation is that you weigh first review and approve the following actions to eliminate the grade 8 writing test in spring of 24 to coincide with the implementation of the grade 8 integrated reading and writing test component as a required part of the grade 8 reading sol test and also to adopt the guidelines that dr sasperry just reviewed that would recommend the use of the integrated reading and writing item could serve as a means

[03:26:38] of meeting that assessment requirement again we are asking you to waive first reviews so that school divisions have sufficient time to integrate these changes and reflect them in their instructional practices, as I said earlier, we believe that eliminating the grade eight writing test will support the use of integrated reading and writing instruction. And we also believe that school divisions will need some time to determine whether or not they want to move forward with the current balanced assessment plan and a local alternative assessment for grade five writing, or if they want to choose to use the recommendation that they allow the integrated reading and writing type

[03:27:18] to serve as meeting that requirement okay thank you uh ms holton thank you both uh for your work and for your presentation today uh i'm i'm concerned about waiting for review on this matter it does seem to be pretty substantive and to be removing the eighth grade test recognizing we're not uh we're replacing it essentially but we're removing it it seems to me to be a significant

[03:27:50] enough change that normally I think of waiving first review only on a on technical matters or something where there's some legal mandate that we can't meet and I just wonder whether it would make more sense to give the divisions the superintendents the educators etc parents others an opportunity to come back and talk to us I think writing you know I know when we reduced writing tests before when we discuss writing tests before you know those tests were cumbersome and hard to grade expensive and all of that but now we're in an era where large language systems can

[03:28:28] help us help us improve the quality of our testing and reduce the cost of testing on this and is this the right way to go um integrating these tests i i i fully expect that it is the right way to go that you all who know this much better than i ever will are recommending the right thing but to do it on a rush basis without hearing uh without giving i do see that there are a couple of of concerns expressed um i think it's two letters we have from roano county and perhaps you can address those concerns i don't fully understand them what's raised in those those their public

[03:29:06] comment and you also mentioned that we had this on our agenda earlier this spring if that's so i I missed it. But if I'm sorry, in spring of 22, we talked with you about this new item. I see. I see. So, okay, a year ago. So it wasn't this specific, obviously, because or if it was this specific, then I don't know why this matter didn't come before us much earlier so that we wouldn't be having to rush now. So can you address why we can't wait till July to finalize this?

[03:29:36] Dr. Coons, I believe that as you've worked with superintendents, you have gotten some feedback on this particular item. We've met with seven region superintendents and are scheduled this afternoon to meet with our eighth region in Richmond. Given the events last week, we would have had that meeting ahead of time, but definitely pause that. But superintendents have overwhelmingly been excited about this opportunity. We have heard clearly from every part of the state about reducing assessments reducing being able to integrate more

[03:30:12] item types that provide windows into students thinking like a writing item type does allows for better instructional practice as shelley talked about in her presentation we have not heard any concerns whatsoever in our conversations with superintendents across the state that's a question what about our conversation with teachers i've heard some concern from english teachers that we are de-emphasizing writing to uh and so uh i agree with this whole i appreciate this whole question i would add the friendly amendment when she said the different groups who might be concerned to want input i would add teachers pretty strongly to that list so my

[03:30:50] question is twofold like what have we done to engage teachers and then second sort of more generally i think a reasonable person could look at this and be like okay we are actually further de-emphasizing writing so could you speak to why that is not the case as we think systemically in k-12 don't think the intent is to de-emphasize writing it's actually to emphasize writing by having students write about what they have read and i think the the focus in this particular item type on the passages being history or science content really would serve to reinforce the idea

[03:31:29] of writing across the curriculum which I think is something we would want to encourage in the shift to write about what you've learned so you've learned from text what are you writing about text it actually signals best practice in writing instruction rather than as Shelley spoke to taking writing and teaching it in isolation for a separate test it signals that writing should come from text and that's the intent of the shift integrated part is really exciting I I think I just have we were what have we heard from teachers on this.

[03:32:02] I mean, I do share like first first and final review on a Nora is one thing on something like this. It is a little different. Yes, sir. Yeah, I'd like to have a question, but but I like to also hear from the superintendent. If slowing down for a month, it creates a huge problem that I'm not aware of.

[03:32:21] I did the field testing for the integrated item types is underway. what's the timeline to get results on how those did, how they fare, what outcomes that we have. We just finished administering the field test. So I don't know how soon that happens.

[03:32:37] Again, as you all know, everybody knows I'm a fan of modernizing the assessment system. I definitely supported replacing assessments when we did, but I have since then grieved the loss of grade five writing because it was a performance task. At the time it was onerous to administer and grade, technology has caught up with that i think we have seen the impact on grade eight writing as a result so i i i i'm definitely excited about the more modernized assessments that can do more etc um i'm just a question if if where we are in the timeline and maybe a little bit of feedback

[03:33:13] on if we have any about how the field testing is going i'm going to defer to the experts on so that the field test is complete and we now have readers who are scoring those responses and so that's underway and then we'll have committees of teachers meet this summer they will review some of the prompts and make recommendations as to whether they should be used moving forward in 2024. later this fall we will have what's called range finding committees

[03:33:51] see mr gecker another word for you as you leave range finding exactly right so and in those committee meetings um the teachers will select um particular writing samples that will exemplify each of the score points and then we'll provide that to to school divisions so that's where we are in the process mr president yes sir um i'm also cautious about hearing and making a vote on the first day um however after hearing the presentation that you've presented also knowing

[03:34:28] that this is the recommendation from dr coons um i fully support the team and their belief that this needs to be done today so that the process can move forward that's all i have sultan may i ask was there any response to mr rotherham's question about of the stakeholder of the teacher stakeholder groups educators take over groups so while we have not uh asked teachers directly about eliminating the test over the years um they have been involved in developing the new item type the teacher

[03:35:03] committees that i mentioned um so they they are well aware of the new item type i think over the past probably five or six years we have heard lots of calls from the field to eliminate the grade eight writing test so i i don't think that is i don't think that um request is something used

[03:35:25] anybody else um your thoughts on june versus july uh please i honestly would defer to um dr lovingrider because she understands the assessment system in virginia as i'm coming online i understand assessments but the system and the timing and what that impact is to school divisions, I would refer to Dr. Lovingrider who understands what school divisions need and what we

[03:36:02] need in the assessment system. So I'd prefer she respond. So Dr. Lovingrider, I think that getting noticed that you don't have to do something is considerably different than getting noticed that you have to do something. So that I think is at play here. Are there any other timeline implementation things that June versus July messes up? I think the biggest issue for us is the trying to give the school divisions as much time as possible to adjust for this coming year as you well know dr siebert school divisions typically do their planning for the next year

[03:36:36] during the summer so our thought was knowing on the 15th of june that you're not going to administer grade eight the grade eight writing test anymore and you can adjust your instruction to focus more on writing about what students have read um would be appropriate we also know that i i don't mean to minimize the grade five writing school divisions will have to determine whether or not they want to move forward with the balanced assessment plans i'm struggling with that though shelley because this will happen during pre-service and in service in in later in the summer i'm struggling with that

[03:37:11] this timeline like is going i mean i don't see how is this actually going to impact teachers between this meeting and our next meeting later in july and mr grecker also i think mr handsome is creasy i regret they've had to step out i think they'll be very interested in this this piece too so um let me ask is there a motion of any sort either to defer or to adopt can we make it i would make an alternate motion to accept this on first review second don't need a motion to accept it on first

[03:37:48] review we can we have just accepted it on first and i think that's where the majority of the board is there a majority of the board that's still here who would vote to waive first review i would so okay well you are accepted on first review and thank you very much all right uh the timing can I speak kind of the timing is obviously not ideal school is letting out people are starting their summers but to the extent we can make sure people are aware of this change we get ample opportunity for some yeah I'm not asking for a formal public notice process right if it is the extent with

[03:38:26] stakeholder outreach we can get some feedback between now and the next meeting that'd be great appreciating to federal holidays and school between that but whatever we can do can you clarify what kind of feedback you said stakeholder make sure people know that we took this that this is on first review whatever whatever we normally do to communicate to the field so people who want to be engaged can get particularly particularly teachers and and my understanding is there's there's teachers have various feelings about where we're going on writing and it no one wants to sort of it can be hard to stick your head up but there's some teachers who are sort of concerned

[03:39:04] about the direction we're going we'd be happy to do that opportunity to speak up well and we can definitely put that in front of the teacher advisory council as well so thank you we do item h i'd like to take five minutes and then we'll be back legitimately here at 12 35. can we do that

[03:39:20] it's okay it's a protest there would be no math that's right exactly it all adds up

[03:44:59] good math sorry right so good afternoon president gecker vice president man superintendent coons and esteemed members of the board of education i'm honored today to stand alongside the mathematics team at the virginia department of education including Ms. Tina Mazzecain, Ms. Deborah Delosia, Kristen Williams-Faust, and Dr. Jessica Brown.

[03:45:23] Yesterday, our mathematics team was able to provide a comprehensive overview of the revision process and a preview of the Draft 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning that are being presented to you today for first review. Per the seven-year cycle in the Code of Virginia, the Draft 2023 SOL being presented to the Board of Education today is for first review. The set of standards are being presented in draft form and represent six elementary grade levels K-5, three middle school

[03:45:57] grade levels 6-8, and ten high school courses including Algebra 1, Geometry, and Algebra 2. The Virginia Department of Education is producing two draft documents for formal review by the board including the draft 2023 mathematics sol document which is attachment two in the board document in the board agenda and the 2023 mathematics standards of learning summary documents which provides an overview of revisions which is attachment one in the board agenda item

[03:46:32] through the engagement of a broad array of stakeholders valuable input and feedback informed a revised set of standards that represent the best in class for all students here in the commonwealth since january of 2022 when the mathematics sol revision timeline was first event was first presented to the board the sequence of actions have occurred we have received written and verbal comments from stakeholders we have received um we have convened a review committee of k-12 educators to review public comments and make recommendations for revisions to the

[03:47:11] standards we have developed a draft of the proposed standards and received feedback both electronically and in person from external reviewers on the proposed draft of the standards and we have received support of for the review process from the video e-assessment development staff including providing stem and innovation staff with insights from work with the development of state assessments and other content areas in stem so the proposed revisions to the standards will raise academic

[03:47:48] expectations for students and schools and provide a coherent and vertically articulated set of expectations to educators and families the four overarching areas of focus that emerge during the revision processes avenues to rigor and depth include improving vertical or coherence through the grade levels application and connections of concepts within a greater course additional data analysis to support post-secondary workforce expectations and embedding the math process goals of problem-solving connections communication representation and reasoning yesterday we gave

[03:48:24] you many detailed examples exemplifying each area and we'd like to give you about 25 more today no just kidding so following the board of education's acceptance of the draft 2023 mathematics of standards of learning for first review today the department of education will receive public comment for at least 30 days before beginning the draft 2023 mathematics standards of learning to the board of education for final review in either august or december of 2023 september

[03:48:59] did i say december english is my second language so during the public comment period the board of education or host public hearings, both in-person and virtually, on the Draft 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning. To scare you, we're thinking possibly about three in-person hearings and truthfully

up to 10 virtual hearings. We'll meet you there. So, following the public comment period, the Mathematics Education Advisory Committee, as presented yesterday, will meet to review and consider the feedback received. It is anticipated that the review and

[03:49:38] revision process will be completed in 2023, and the final standards document will be posted to the DOE website after the Board of Education final review in August or September. Please note that today's superintendent's recommendation does show a change from the timeline that was provided to the Board of Education in January 2022 by the Department with the 2024-2025 full implementation of the 2023 Math SOLs.

[03:50:11] Local school divisions will have discretion in determining how to best transition between the 2016 Mathematics SOL and the revised 2023 Mathematics SOL. The VDOE will provide professional learning opportunities for teachers to support implementation of the revised Mathematics SOL, along with implementation documents that can support school divisions.

[03:50:34] The VDOE wants to ensure that school divisions have a smooth transition and to be able to make that shift in instruction for students. Educators across the Commonwealth need to be commended for their hard work and dedication to provide high-quality mathematics instruction to all students, and we want them to recognize that the VDOE staff wants to work collaboratively with them to ensure continued success in meeting the needs of our students. Instruction based on high-quality standards will ensure that all students have access to educational opportunities that prepare

[03:51:11] them for success in the workplace communities and our democracy so therefore the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education receive for first review the proposed revisions to the 2016 mathematics standards of learning and consideration of full implementation in 2024-2025. Thank you for your time and attention during this presentation. The mathematics team and I will be happy to answer any questions that you may have. We have any questions for the

[03:51:48] mathematics team or Dr. Albin? I have a comment. Sure. Dr. Sieber. First of all, last night, whatever it was, really deep thoughts, great work. Really excited about the new math standards and that's part of the reason why i'm you know excited about students having the benefits of these new math standards we talked a little bit last night about the the timeline so i think as we receive these first reviews we know what the board does that we continue to talk about that uh we had a great conversation last night about support and so i'm encouraged by that uh serving america city

[03:52:25] public schools our superintendent dr white really often says you know help has to feel like help so we want to make sure that as we craft it and so i think the regional approach those things are good but you know many of you very kindly defer me as my experience as superintendent but the best job i ever had public education was elementary principal and and so as i think about the timeline you know i've been a school leader at the middle in the high school level and and i anticipate more content focus there content support so i think you know aggressive timelines there but my my heart my cause as we move forward this and think about timeline is elementary elementary teachers are teaching multiple content areas they are implementing the virginia literacy act they

[03:53:03] Tim Cynova: They are implementing new history social studies standards and now the math standards and that just doesn't leave a lot of air. Tim Cynova: In the room for for those elementary teachers

so as we as we receive these and we move forward let's continue thinking about the timelines and and and you know the side that I just that's where I am.

[03:53:29] I won't repeat what I said yesterday but except to say again great work. And as to Mr. Siebert's points about the timeline, one additional thought since yesterday is somebody's helping me think about how do we field test these.

[03:53:47] I appreciate the goal of accelerating implementation. These new guidelines, the new standards seem terrific. We want to get them in place as quickly as possible. how do we get from here to there is the challenge and if we accept robust public comment as you're proposing which i think is wonderful it's it's going to be some some degree into the school year before these standards are adopted uh for many divisions and and if many of the divisions choose not to implement not to do any crosswalk essentially in the content they teach in the

[03:54:25] 23-24 school year how are we going to effectively field test the items from the new standards for instance so it's just you know we we do a slow transition traditionally we have done a slow transition for a lot of reasons i don't i don't think it needs to be two years but how we accelerate it effectively is a little bit of a mystery to me and so before we approve which i assume that some point we'll be asked to approve the accelerated timeline before we are asked to vote on that i

[03:55:01] hope you all will have both conferred with the divisions and come back to us with a plan that makes that we can understand about how we can effectively accelerate without um imposing unrealistic expectations on the divisions for 23 24. miss holton we're happy to provide a presentation with that timeline and how assessment would fit into that prior to the approval of the final standards both then thinking through the elementary component and how we support our elementary teachers in a reasonable way and also how we make sure the field testing is thoroughly vetted and those kinds of things so thank you for the feedback and where are we on the virginia

[03:55:36] numeracy act because certainly for the literacy component you know we got a lot of additional funds to provide assistance in schools to you know help support that portion of our work you Mayor Mrakas: You know, it would seem to me that one of the concerns is teacher support the funding coming through something like the numeracy act would be an important component of where we're going.

[03:55:58] Mayor Mrakas: I know it doesn't bear directly on the standards, but it does bear on the implementation piece we are we've had some light conversation at this point. Mayor Mrakas: I mean, perhaps it would behoove the board and you know the office to make sure that that particular thing doesn't go off the radar too fast.

[03:56:20] I just want to mention two of the three things, again, shout out to all you did. The other thing is on the public hearing piece, you know, I am happy to use my calendar, look for a chance to head to Southwest Virginia. People throughout the Commonwealth routinely make the migrations to Richmond, and I know from the history standards work and other things that Region 7 in particular appreciated us making the effort to go there.

[03:56:45] So, you know, again, I appreciate trying to be efficient, but in terms of making sure the you know region six seven eight whatever included i'm happy to to sign up to be the board member there certainly we do appreciate that so um in the timeline that we shared with you yesterday when we received initial public input on the 2016 standards we did go out to several places in the commonwealth at that

point so what we've tried to do is when we do our in-person public feedback on proposed standards is to go to different regions that we did not hit last time so there will be a

[03:57:23] slight variance that way but yes we'll we'll be happy to share that with you once the board approves then we'll be able to confirm the dates we do have tentative dates dr siever it's one of my favorite places to be i'll go out there with you okay any other comments or questions if not thanks very much to the math team thank you dr alvin and the board is happy to receive this on

[03:57:47] first review thank you congratulations yep okay a couple presentations miss sika guys keep hiding back there there good afternoon good afternoon again thank you i will be presenting on the

[03:58:19] exemplar awards the announcement of the exemplar awards provides the virginia board of education the opportunity to recognize schools school divisions or school boards for excellence the three categories within the exemplar awards are high achievement continuous improvement and innovative practices 48 schools in virginia are currently receiving the highest achievement award as a high achievement award-winning school not only did students at these schools

[03:58:54] demonstrates success in reading math and science pass rates but each group also met the same rigorous benchmarks in reading and mathematics each student group also met the same rigorous benchmarks in reading and mathematics in addition student growth performance was near at or above the performance rate for all students 69 schools in Virginia are currently receiving the continuous improvement award for academic improvement these schools have demonstrated at least a 10 point improvement in the combined accreditation rates over the previous three accreditation years in

[03:59:31] reading math and science for the all students group two or more student groups in reading and math 24 schools are receiving the continuous improvement award for increasing the graduation and completion index over the last three accreditation years by four percent or more as well as decreasing the dropout rate by at least 15 percent over the past three years the last category of school is is the innovative practice award seven school divisions and one school are receiving this award schools receiving this award have embraced innovative and creative

[04:00:10] practices to enhance student experiences they have implemented practices such as using virtual reality tools to allow students to create new content and to create strong curricular connections developing strategies to enhance teacher retention and recruitment implementing a system to promote a school environment that cultivates the physical emotional and intellectual well-being of students and developing and implementing a regional approach with local businesses to provide

[04:00:45] apprenticeship opportunities for students. Two school divisions are implementing creative approaches to provide enhanced STEM offerings in the school division and one recipient is providing well-orchestrated opportunities that align with the division's profile of a graduate and provide service learning opportunities for students. The names of the schools in the divisions who have received this award in each of the categories are outlined within the report to the board and they're also located on the department of education website i'd like to thank dr siebert

[04:01:24] and miss creasy for their time participating as executive reviewers of the selection process and i would like to now turn it over to dr siebert miss creasy president vector dr coons and other board members should you have comments any questions or comments it was neat to see behind the curtain of the great work that the staff do to vet and prepare and so uh you know miss creasy and i our our role was

kind of like to to validate that and very thorough very solid rubrics very thoughtful work um so it was kind of neat to see behind the curtain the great work we all know the

[04:02:02] staff is great work which is another opportunity to see that really excited for these school divisions to show excellence, innovation, and improvement, and the opportunity to recognize the hard work that our school divisions are doing. Just really proud of the opportunity. I do think there's going to be a press release coming out today as well. I think so. Okay. Well, thank you so much.

[04:02:24] Mr. Chapman. Yes, President Gecker, Vice President Dr. Mann, members of the board, and Dr. Koons, thank you for giving me the honor of closing out your items for today.

[04:02:41] and this won't be brief it's an update from the college partnership laboratory standing committee which you have a letter included in your agenda material the standing committee met on june 5th and one of the really exciting things to come out of this this meeting is that we had two applications for college partnership laboratory schools that were received on first review by the standing committee and were subsequently approved for public comment those two applications in to give you just an idea of what should be coming your way soon south side virginia community college

[04:03:19] has an application in partnership with mecklenburg county public schools and the committee heard from numerous stakeholders involved about the the partnership programs in order to open up career pathways with the south side career academy that they are planning one of One of the really fun folks that we heard from was from Microsoft, who's who's working in partnership, you know, on career pathways.

[04:03:43] The other application was Commonwealth, the Virginia Commonwealth University, in collaboration with Code RVA, you know, obviously one of the flagship schools in Virginia on innovation. And then the standing committee heard detailed information on VCU's teacher residency program, and also Code RVA's, you know, personalized, integrated, and really applied learning, you objectives in their curriculum and how these two could partnership in a very new way, you know, under the lab school model. As I mentioned, both applications were approved for public comment.

[04:04:16] VEOE has since designed a public comment form. That application, those public comment forms are live right now, and so we are receiving public comment that will return to the Standing Committee for its next meeting on July 7th, and then in anticipation that those applications will be able to to be presented to this body at the July board meeting.

[04:04:38] Additionally, you know, in other news, Roanoke College was approved for a planning grant. So real exciting to see the continued expansion of those planning grants. And of course, how those will inevitably, you know, result in more applications to be considered by the Standing Committee and then, you know, by this body.

[04:04:56] Can't thank you enough for the incredible work from Dr. Rayleigh, you know, who's added an immense amount of leadership into that standing committee, but also the very hard work of the standing committee itself, which is Mrs. Joan Wideszka, who's the chair, Dr. Pam Moran, who is the vice chair, Mr. John Bailey, and then two other guys.

[04:05:19] Our board members, of course, Mr. Rotherham and Mr. Hanson. And of course, Mr. Rotherham, if you have any additional comments. - No, that was a great report. I would second the endorsement of Dr. Reilly's terrific work because it has been a really big help for us um and you all should

check out the heat there's a heat map uh that shows where the planning grants are and there's you know getting these two out for public comment is exciting there's a lot of really cool ideas uh percolating and so it's an exciting time on this thank you thank you thank you okay we are down to uh

[04:05:58] discussion of current issues any current issues i want to give the board just a quick staffing update um we will be having a new chief academic officer deputy of teaching and learning start on july 10th her name is marcy sorenson she has done national leading work i will definitely send out more information but want to tell you that we have an addition um kim ritchie has left us she has become the deputy chancellor at the florida department of education so a great opportunity for her to increase her capacity and continue to show leadership across state development work

[04:06:37] in florida but we are actively recruiting for that we will be having several new assistant superintendents come online that we'll be excited to share in july we are in the interview process and excited to share a new assistant superintendent of ed prep a new assistant superintendent of innovation and a new assistant superintendent of um instruction yep so we'll have um we'll be starting to round out our leadership team by the next um board meeting but really excited to have um people coming on board and then people using all the great work in virginia to expand

[04:07:15] and continue their careers so we're excited about that i also don't know if charles pile is in the room is charles pile in the room could he come out behind the tv for just a second charles pile has done amazing amazing work at the department of education he has led our communications he has led our strategy he has led a great deal of change management over his course at the department now i'm not going to tear up but he's been an incredible mentor and connector for me over

[04:07:52] the past two months and helped me um learn the ways of virginia and the department of ed has chosen to retire so i just want to recognize and honor charles he does not know this i'm getting the death look he does not know this but i just want to honor and thank charles i could not have had a better two months and getting to know virginia without him so i'm incredibly blessed and honored to be able to um work with him for a short time before he goes to do really cool fun things but appreciate you thank you for your kind words dr coons they're they're deeply appreciated

[04:08:27] and uh um it's been a pleasure working with with all of you um some for a short time some for a much longer time mr gecker of course i've known andy and worked with andy for uh mr rotherham i'm sorry for i think my entire career with the department going back to uh the early days of the standards of learning um you're both older than you look at least one of them it's been a pleasure serving you know boards of education appointed by uh you know seven different governors

[04:09:02] over the years and getting to know the board members and appreciate your kind thoughts and i would like to say it's also been a pleasure of leading and being led by i think the most talented communications team in state government including the current members and the incredible communications professionals that it was my honor to lead in the past as well so thank you

[04:09:32] president gecker i also want to thank you personally i've not had the opportunity to say this but your leadership from the day i was announced to the support and ongoing collaboration has really been tremendously powerful and helpful to me and i think we have had more conversations while i've been learning how to figure out my way around richmond i'm incredibly blessed and thankful for the opportunity to serve with you and dr man coming

[04:10:07] from someone who is a massive champion of our earliest learners and the importance of earliest learners and the awe in which i walked into the work that has been done in virginia i honor and thank you for that and also want to thank you for recognizing the challenges that happened in richmond last week i just want to lift up the family at huguenot high school i was able to do their closing ceremony and was very graciously invited to witness the resilience of that staff and the conversations of resilience and the focus on the children and how they support the children

[04:10:43] moving forward it's just an um powerful an incredibly powerful moment to remember why we do this work and how important it is to support our our schools and our school division so thank you for the moment well same response that number one i'm happy to have been here when you got here and uh i am incredibly grateful that you are here i think you will do great things for the commonwealth you know it's based upon relatively short but as you said we've had a lot of conversation the last couple months and i'm 100 convinced that you are 100 dedicated to the work

[04:11:22] and i appreciate that greatly anybody else everybody else but where do you want to start yeah no no yeah we're not doing that no well i want to i want to say a quick word i want to say a quick word about charles that's how i'll slip in um uh he really does leave big shoes to fill has been just a terrific uh public servant it's a big it's a big loss for the department uh dr mann i do want to thank you on early ed just watching from the sidelines as like this became more of a central issue for the commonwealth and and i mean not just something we heard about today but just over the last few years like a greater emphasis on making sure we're getting

[04:11:59] kids off to a good start is is terrific and you will be missed and president gecker yeah i just want to say thank you um i'm terrible at this i'm worse than grace um look the last year could have been a real train wreck and there was frankly a lot of people hoping it was going to be a train wreck and cheering for that and who would have you would have been a hero amongst them for doing that um and i know like i'm a native virginian like other people i know one of our ways here is we don't speak directly but i do just want to speak directly thank you um you did just an incredible job in a unique and difficult circumstance and i don't think everyone would have risen to the

[04:12:37] occasion like that and it's just a tremendous credit to you um vice president dr mann it has has been a pleasure to work with you in a short time. Being a new guy, I'm trying to figure out who's who. And it didn't take long to figure out when you spoke, people would listen. Nassim, she has a strong background, a lot of knowledge to share with this board. So I want to personally thank you for the service that you've given to the Commonwealth. And I know you're going to

[04:13:14] continue to serve. And I'm sure I'm going to be hearing about the great work that you're going to continue to be doing. To our president, Mr. Gecker, I was joking with you the other day, I said it's good to be on the same side of a vote with you and you reminded me it wasn't the only time so leadership leadership is key in any organization I've watched you I've listened to you and I I've seen up close and personal what a strong leader leader should do and has done for

[04:13:48] many years so this board the commonwealth I'm thankful to have served with you even though it short um i've seen a lot of points that you've made i've learned from and i'm going to hold on to um i think i'm the new guy that's ready to go go go and i don't like delays um i like to fully support the staff and the superintendent which i will do but from watching the leadership of the vice president and the president i see why you were chosen to be there so i just want to personally

[04:14:23] thank you thank you and as a teacher i think most teachers who become hopefully good teachers hope was a good teacher. We are professional appropriators. That means we are always stealing good ideas from other teachers. And so we go through our profession looking for things that we can pick up and use and carry forward. And so it was always great to get a great lesson plan from a fellow science teacher, get a pearl of wisdom from a fellow assistant principal or principal, gather with superintendents and glean their ideas and wisdom. But my compliment to you

[04:15:00] to is not only have I learned practical things about governance and the commonwealth and this institution, which we want you both to know we are going to honor and support, but being around you, there's other pearls of wisdom that come up, the kind that not just in fluency as a professional educator, but as a husband and a father.

[04:15:21] And so I thank you both. - This is not obligatory, Ann, you know. - I will be brief because I can't possibly share the context we have my immense gratitude to you it's been such a pleasure to serve with you and to watch you serve the children and the educators of virginia and the families of virginia so admirably and and it's been especially a treat to get to know you on the board over these four years we haven't worked together i knew you only by your wonderful reputation before

[04:16:01] we came together here and it's been especially wonderful to get to know you and watch your great work and i know you as with uh president gecker have many many years of public service um in your future in all kinds of uh avenues i'm sure and i look forward to watching your path forward um and and dan i'm just not gonna try to say it much because i can't say it without without losing it but um you and i've worked together right back to the eight years almost oh my gosh i'm back to the time when i was secretary and there's been a lot of water over the dam between then and now but throughout you have raised the bar on the institution of the board

[04:16:40] of education its reputation in the commonwealth and its effectiveness and um i i pledge to you we uh we we the new the newly constituted board as of july 1 will carry that ball dr man i um was so happy to know that um you were someone who knew early childhood the way that you do and understand it in a way that i always continue to hope to get there i haven't worked in early

[04:17:20] childhood space as long as you but i have certainly learned so much from you in in this last year and and I'm forever thankful for your educating me continually, helping to make my professional knowledge deeper.

[04:17:38] And we're certainly gonna miss you. As I said earlier, this is a really hard one because Dan and I have gotten pretty close over the last year and anything, I mean, personal or having to do with this board, I've reached out and Dan's been there for me.

[04:18:03] And I just hope you know how much I appreciate it. And I will see you soon. - Yep, no doubt. Dr. Mann, I know you had some comments.

[04:18:23] - Wow, and I really will be brief. I will say it's been an honor to have been invited to serve in this capacity. And I think it was especially special that, you know, three actions that the board took today sort of put a bow on my why really at the end of the day when when the call came and the opportunity was shared my why was about the importance of the foundational years of a child's life and how

[04:18:59] precious and important that is and if we're going to take up the mantle to own that space we must respect what it means to do that and to do that well and so it really it really was remarkable to have

that be a part of um my last meeting here and i will say over the last four years the thing that i am really really i've learned i've tried to contribute where i can but i am also very overwhelmed by all that i have been able to learn and much of it really is a reflection of

[04:19:38] the incredible asset that this department this institution of education has in its public servants i just want to say to see staff come sit present be prepared to address questions really when you think about it this is an institution and we are fortunate that continuity and knowledge and understanding is fundamental to the success of the endeavors that we are asked to deliberate on and we owe a great debt of gratitude to every public servant that has said yes to come

[04:20:18] to serve to be a part of the videoe we could not do what we do absent that and i feel it's hard to do that because governance changes a lot and yet the commitment to mission the commitment to children the commitment to educators keeps good people here and my hope is that we will continue to acknowledge and celebrate what they mean to the work of education and the commonwealth i learned so

[04:20:50] much more angoff what was the term today the modified angolf method modified and got a rain i mean there's just finding range finding oh the vocabulary of all that encompasses the things that this board has had to deliberate my mind has really been expanded and it's been expanded in important ways because i can be an ambassador on the ground for people who just don't know how difficult it is to do all that's done to make sure all children have a quality education and and

[04:21:27] my hope really is not very different from what i know led to you all saying yes to serve and is that we're going to always center children and educators in our minds i am telling you literally there are times when i am picturing in my mind not my children i am fortunate that my children received a good education here in the commonwealth and their young adults off doing well but i am thinking about the faces of children that i may not know but i know are in classrooms around the commonwealth and i'm thinking about educators who are showing up

[04:22:02] every day under some of the most challenging circumstances our system of education has ever faced and we have to keep them in mind as we aspire to raise the bar and raise the bar to ensure that our children are prepared but we have to make sure we are wrapping around the supports they need to do what we're asking them to do mental health wise compensation wise support wise it all matters and i hope that you will keep that in the center of your minds as you deliberate the things that will surely come before you in the months and years to come and just thank you for

[04:22:41] giving me an opportunity to be here mr gecker i will never forget my very first board experience with you and dr lane you welcomed me you invited me to come for lunch to sit and understand what is it that you are interested in wanting to contribute it set this it set the stuck the bar for like understanding we're all here to get something done and let's let's let's get to that and i appreciate so very much the leadership you have exhibited in sharing and leading during the

[04:23:20] time I've been privileged to serve alongside you so thank you for your service okay uh it's not really my style to do public stuff like this but I'm going to say a few things you know first a quick story uh you know eight years ago I had just finished serving seven and a half years more accurately just finished serving my second term as a board member in Chesterfield uh I got tasked to run for state senate lost that election uh this is 2015 at the beginning of 16 i got a phone call that said would you be interested in serving on the board of ed and oh by the way secretary holton

[04:23:59] would like then secretary holton would like to meet with you to talk about you know what's involved in the position so you know you don't turn ann down and so i went to the obligatory meeting in the obligatory coffee shop and we sat there for a while and ann said i just want you to know that this is a working board and you need to be prepared to work and i said okay and i get that it's a working board i'm prepared to work and you know we talked about a few other things and then she came back and said i just want you to understand just how hard the work is said okay you know i'm capable of hard work you know used to do it in one time in my life and i'm sure i can do it again

[04:24:38] and you know a few other things happened and then she said for the third time this is a really hard job and you know i began to realize that ann didn't think i could really do this i have served i guess not quite as long as charles but uh three governors four secretaries of education and seven superintendents or acting superintendents of public instruction which you know i wish that were just a measure of the length of time but in part it's a measure of the instability at times of the system which you know is something that i am concerned about

[04:25:14] long term the system needs more stability than we've had over the past few years but you know i had a lot prepared to talk about you know my view of the institution of the or the board as an institution however i am very grateful that a number of you have mentioned today that that lesson doesn't need to be taught again that all of us are here just for a brief time to do our part to move the goals of the institution forward and to play our part in the education system in the commonwealth you know we only really get to do two things two categories of

[04:25:49] things you know first is those things we're tasked to do mandated to do by either the general assembly or by some federal rules and those we don't have a lot of choice over but there's a fairly significant category of things that we have authority over uh either through the constitution or through the general assembly things we've been delegated to do and you know it's those things that as an institution we are able as members and you guys going forward will be able as members to test the actions we're taking or the board is taking against the stated goal of the commonwealth

[04:26:24] which is to provide a high educational program of high quality for all of our children and you know i think doing this work with all the respect to hands you know assessment of it is not that hard when simplified down to is what we're voting on going to move the agenda forward or is it not i mean every task we have can be boiled down to that um you know i am very grateful to have been here it's you know when i left local office i didn't think anything would be as satisfying but

[04:27:04] i will tell you that uh although locally you can get things done a little bit more quickly that the length of time it takes to get anything done at the state level is lengthened uh you know i look at what we've done over the last over my last seven and a half and i'm pretty happy with where we are i mean as tammy said the virginia literacy act and the you know fall fall out the product of that but there's been a lot of things we've done that i think uh over the seven and a half years that will be meaningful in the future including by the way and the one thing i will ask

[04:27:41] you guys to do is the standards of quality uh you know i understand that there may be places to tinker with it but i do believe that the underlying concepts are sound and i hope this board continues to fulfill its obligation which we hadn't done in over 20 years to prescribe standards of quality i will say i appreciate all the friendships i've made grace of course and special thanks to ann who overcame her reluctance and let them nominate me anyway you know people who aren't here anymore Sal Romero,

Octae Basil, who Anne might remember, Elizabeth Lodl, and Jim Dillard, all of whom were members of the first board. And, you know, as a non-educator coming into the board,

[04:28:21] having folks who were educators to take you under the wing and mentor you and explain what was supposed to happen was particularly helpful. Billy Cannaday, my old friend from Chesterfield, who is like the educator from Central Casting, all right, he's done everything, you know, superintendent public you know superintendent of public instruction local superintendent uh you know billy was great and provided that role model for how to be gracious in everything you do billy is an incredibly gracious human being uh my three vice chairs you know diane atkinson

[04:28:56] who uh you know still love dearly you know diane is incredible knowledge and an incredible heart jamel wilson who sadly was taken from the board too soon in that act of political revenge but whose credentials and caring for the work of the board were certainly beyond question.

[04:29:16] And of course, Dr. Mann, clearly an expert in your field and has been mentioned many times today through the examples from your life, teach all of us so much. So thank you. That's about it. It is my prerogative as chair to have the last word.

[04:29:35] And guys, we are adjourned.

[04:29:56] - I can do this.

